

VanMitra

Community Forest Rights (CFR) Claim Module

Detailed Procedure Workflow, Statutory Mapping and System Architecture

A statute-anchored design specification for the CFR claim module of the VanMitra platform, derived from the Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006; the Rules of 2007 as substantially amended by the Amendment Rules, 2012; and the Ministry of Tribal Affairs Guidelines on implementation. The specification covers the end-to-end claim procedure, the authorities and officers involved at every stage, the complete document and evidence set, the module architecture, and the technology stack.

AWARENESS → CLAIM → VERIFICATION → RESOLUTION → RECOGNITION → RECORD → GOVERNANCE

Prepared for pilot implementation and stakeholder review
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Document Control

Item	Detail
Document title	VanMitra — CFR Claim Module: Detailed Procedure Workflow and System Architecture
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Scope	Module 3 (FRA/CFR Digital Case Management) of the VanMitra architecture, restricted to the Community Forest Resource claim under Section 3(1)(i) , with its dependencies on Modules 4 (Evidence), 6 (Workflow Tracker), 8/9 (GIS and participatory mapping) and 12/13 (Gram Sabha governance).
Out of scope	Individual Forest Rights (Form A) processing detail, habitat rights of PVTGs under Section 3(1)(e), livelihood and market modules, satellite monitoring beyond the post-title alert hook.
Primary sources	FRA 2006 (Act 2 of 2007); FR Rules 2007 as amended 2012; MoTA Guidelines on implementation of the Act; Marathi notification of the 2012 Amendment Rules; VanMitra Final Application Architecture; VanMitra FRA/CFR On-Ground Implementation Scheme.
Design rule	Every screen, field, state transition and document in this module is traceable to a numbered provision of the Act, the Rules or the Guidelines. Any feature that cannot be traced is treated as a facilitation convenience and is marked as such.
Legal position	VanMitra is a community-side facilitation and record system. It does not adjudicate, approve, reject or vest any right. All statutory decisions remain exclusively with the Gram Sabha, SDLC, DLC and SLMC.

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1 Purpose, Scope and How to Read This Document

The VanMitra architecture describes seventeen modules. This document takes one of them — the CFR claim — and specifies it to build level. It exists because the claim module is the only module where a software defect can cause a *legal* injury: a missing evidence tag, an unrecorded quorum, an unsigned verification proceeding or a lost sixty-day limitation period can each be enough for a claim to be rejected, and rejection of a Community Forest Resource claim affects an entire village rather than one household.

The document is therefore organised so that each engineering artefact sits next to the provision that forces it:

Section	What it gives you	What it is derived from
2 — Legal foundation	The definition of the claim being automated and the ten binding constraints the software must not violate.	Sections 2(a), 3(1)(i), 4, 5, 6 of the Act; Rules 2(1)(ca), 4, 11, 12, 12A, 12B.
3 — Authorities	Every officer and department the module must model, with designation, department and system role.	Rules 3, 5, 7, 9; Section 11; state-level implementation practice.
4 — Documents	The complete document and evidence set: what the community brings, what the module generates, what the authorities return.	Forms A, B, C; Rule 13(1) and 13(2); Annexures II, III, IV, V.
5 — Workflow	Thirteen stages with actor, trigger, statutory clock, system action and exit criteria.	Section 6; Rules 11, 12, 12A, 12B, 14, 15, 16.
6 — Architecture	Layered architecture, state machine, data model, API surface, offline sync, integrity design, deployment.	Engineering derivation from sections 2-5.
7 — Technology	Component-by-component stack with the reason each component is chosen and its fallback.	VanMitra technical architecture, extended.

Reading convention. Square brackets carry the statutory citation, for example *[Rule 12(1)(g)]*. **STATUTORY** marks behaviour the law compels; **DERIVED** marks an engineering decision that implements it; **FACILITATION** marks a convenience feature with no statutory basis, which may be switched off without affecting legal validity.

2 Legal Foundation of the CFR Claim

2.1 What is actually being claimed

A Community Forest Resource claim is not a land ownership claim. It is a claim to **recognition of the community's pre-existing right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage** a customary common forest area *[Section 3(1)(i)]*. The area itself is defined by Section 2(a) as customary common forest land within the traditional or customary boundaries of the village, or the seasonal use of landscape in the case of pastoral communities, and it expressly includes reserved forests, protected forests and protected areas such as sanctuaries and national parks to which the community had traditional access. The title issued is a community title in Annexure IV, held by the Gram Sabha, and it is explicitly stated that no conditions may be imposed on the right beyond those in the Act and Rules.

The module must keep three claim types clearly separated, because they use different forms, different evidence and different title annexures.

Claim type	Statutory right	Claim form	Title issued	Holder and character
IFR — Individual Forest Rights	Section 3(1)(a), (f), (g), (m); Section 4(8)	Form A <i>[Rule 11(1)(a)]</i>	Annexure II <i>[Rule 8(h)]</i>	Individual or family; heritable but not alienable or transferable; capped at four hectares of land under actual occupation <i>[Section 4(4), 4(6)]</i> .
CR — Community Rights	Section 3(1)(b), (c), (d), (e), (h), (j), (k), (l) — see the definition inserted as Rule 2(1)(ca)	Form B <i>[Rule 11(1)(a), 11(4)]</i>	Annexure III <i>[Rule 8(h)]</i>	Community; nistar, minor forest produce, grazing, water bodies, habitat, biodiversity and traditional knowledge rights.
CFR — Community Forest Resource	Section 3(1)(i) read with Section 2(a)	Form C <i>[Rule 11(4), inserted 2012]</i>	Annexure IV <i>[Rule 8(i)]</i>	Gram Sabha; right to protect, regenerate, conserve and manage; carries the Section 5 duties and the Rule 4(1)(e)(f) management committee obligation.

Consequence for the module. A village normally files *all three* in the same claim cycle. The data model therefore treats `cfr_case` as one row of a general `case` table discriminated by `claim_type`, so that Form A, B and C cases in a village share the same Gram Sabha meeting, the same quorum record and the same evidence pool without duplication of effort in the field.

2.2 Provision-to-feature traceability matrix

This is the controlling table of the specification. Every row is a legal obligation; the right column is the module feature that discharges it. If a feature in the codebase does not appear in this table, it is a facilitation feature and must be labelled as such in the UI.

Provision	What the law requires	Module feature that implements it
Section 6(1)	The Gram Sabha is the authority to initiate determination of the nature and extent of rights, to	The Gram Sabha is modelled as the case owner. No case can leave <code>GS_RESOLVED</code> without a linked resolution record and a

	receive, consolidate and verify claims, to prepare a map delineating each recommended claim, to pass a resolution and to forward it to the SDLC.	linked boundary geometry.
Rule 2A	Hamlets, habitations, unrecorded or unsurveyed settlements, forest villages and taungya villages must be listed, passed by their own Gram Sabha, consolidated by the SDO and finalised by the DLC.	Village registry supports a <code>parent_village</code> / hamlet hierarchy with a <code>consolidation_status</code> field, so a hamlet can hold its own case before it is formalised.
Rule 3(1)	FRC of not less than ten and not more than fifteen persons, at least two-thirds Scheduled Tribes, not less than one-third women.	FRC constitution screen refuses to save a committee that fails the arithmetic; the composition certificate is generated automatically.
Rule 3(3)	An FRC member who is himself a claimant must inform the committee and must not participate in verification of his own claim.	Conflict-of-interest flag on <code>frc_member</code> ; the verification screen hides the sign-off control for a member linked to that claim and records the recusal.
Rule 4(1)(e)(f)(g)	The Gram Sabha constitutes a committee for protection of wildlife, forest and biodiversity (in practice the CFRMC), monitors it, and approves its conservation and management plan, transit permit decisions and use of income.	Post-title CFRMC module is unlocked by the title event; the management plan is stored as a resolution-linked artefact.
Rule 4(2)	Quorum is one-half of all members; at least one-third of those present must be women; where resolutions on forest rights claims are passed, at least fifty per cent of claimants or their representatives must be present; resolutions pass by simple majority of those present and voting.	Quorum calculator runs before the resolution can be recorded, blocks the workflow if any of the three tests fails, and stores the arithmetic as evidence.
Rule 6(b)	The SDLC provides forest and revenue maps and electoral rolls to the Gram Sabha or the FRC.	A tracked request-and-receipt object; if the maps have not been received, the case shows a blocking dependency rather than silently proceeding.
Rule 11(1)(a)	Claims are made within three months of the calling of claims, along with at least two of the evidences in Rule 13; the Gram Sabha may extend the period after recording reasons in writing.	Claim window timer with a formal extension object that requires a reason text and a resolution reference.
Rule 11(1)(b)	The Gram Sabha fixes a date for initiating determination of its community forest resource and intimates adjoining Gram Sabhas where there are substantial overlaps, and the SDLC.	Intimation register; the geo service proposes the adjoining Gram Sabhas automatically from polygon adjacency, and the intimation is recorded with a dispatch date.
Rule 11(3)	Every claim received shall be duly acknowledged in writing by the FRC.	Acknowledgement receipt generated and printed at the moment of claim registration, with a serial number.
Rule 11(4)	The FRC prepares the claim on behalf of the Gram Sabha in Form B for community rights and in Form C for the right over community forest resource.	Form C is authored by the FRC role, not the individual claimant role; the system enforces this in RBAC.
Rule 11(6)	The Secretary of the Gram Panchayat also acts as Secretary to the Gram Sabha.	The Gram Panchayat Secretary is a first-class actor with signing rights on meeting records.
Rule 12(1)(a)-(e)	Site visit and physical verification after due intimation to the claimant and the Forest Department; further evidence received; pastoralist, nomadic, PVTG claims verified when those communities or representatives are present; map with recognisable landmarks prepared.	Field verification workflow with intimation record, presence register and a mandatory landmark set on the map before sign-off.
Rule 12(1)(f)(g)	Customary boundaries delineated with Gram Sabha members including elders well versed in those boundaries; CFR map prepared with recognisable landmarks and substantial evidence under Rule 13(2); the claim approved by simple-majority resolution. The delineation may include reserved forest, protected forest, national parks and sanctuaries.	The participatory mapping session records the elders present as named participants; the map is not valid without at least one Rule 13(2) evidence linked and one landmark per boundary segment.
Rule 12(3)	Conflicting claims over customary boundaries or a forest area used by more than one Gram Sabha are considered in a joint meeting of the respective FRCs; if unresolved, referred to the SDLC.	Overlap detection in PostGIS raises a <code>DISPUTE</code> sub-state, creates a joint-meeting record and, on failure, an SDLC referral packet.
Rule 12(4)	On written request, authorities must provide authenticated copies of records to the Gram Sabha or FRC.	Records request generator with a follow-up clock and an escalation reminder.
Rule 12A(1)	Forest and Revenue officials remain present during verification and sign the proceedings with designation, date and comments.	The verification proceeding sheet has a signature block for each department; the case cannot advance if the block is empty, but an absence can be formally recorded instead.
Rule 12A(2)	If the departments object later on the ground of	Second-absence flag; the system prints the finality note

	absence, the claim is remanded for re-verification; if they again fail to attend, the Gram Sabha decision on field verification is final.	automatically to protect the claim.
Rule 12A(3)	Modification or rejection is communicated in person to the claimant, who may petition within sixty days, extendable by thirty at the committee's discretion.	Limitation timer starts on the recorded date of personal communication, not on the order date; an appeal draft is prepared automatically.
Rule 12A(6)	Incomplete or prima facie inadequate resolutions must be remanded to the Gram Sabha rather than modified or rejected.	REMANDED_TO_GS is a first-class state, distinct from rejection, with its own re-verification checklist.
Rule 12A(7)	Where the DLC does not accept a Gram Sabha or SDLC recommendation, it must record detailed written reasons and supply a copy of the order.	The order document is stored against the case; absence of reasons is itself flagged as an appeal ground in the appeal draft.
Rule 12A(9)	On completion, the Revenue and Forest Departments prepare a final map of the vested forest land and incorporate the right in revenue and forest records within the state record-updation cycle or three months, whichever is earlier.	RECORD_UPDATED is a tracked state with a three-month clock and a record-incorporation evidence slot; a title without record updation stays visibly incomplete.
Rule 12A(10)	No rejection merely on technical or procedural grounds; no committee below the Gram Sabha or FRC, and no individual officer of any rank, may receive, reject, modify or decide a claim.	RBAC contains no role capable of rejecting a claim below SDLC level; any adverse order is recorded with its ground, and a technical-ground order is surfaced as an appeal trigger.
Rule 12A(11)	Committees must consider Rule 13 evidence and must not insist on any particular documentary form. Fine receipts, encroacher lists and offence reports, or their absence, cannot be the sole basis of rejection. Satellite imagery supplements but never replaces other evidence.	The evidence model has no mandatory document type; satellite layers carry a non-substitutable flag and cannot satisfy the two-evidence test alone.
Rule 12B(3)(4)	The DLC ensures CFR rights are recognised in all villages with forest dwellers and titles issued; where no CFR right is recognised in a village, the Secretary of the DLC records the reasons.	District coverage dashboard: villages with forest dwellers and no CFR case are listed as an omission with a reasons field.
Rule 13(3)	The Gram Sabha, SDLC and DLC shall consider more than one of the listed evidences.	Two-evidence sufficiency engine, described in section 4.6.
Rule 8(i)	A certified copy of the record of the right to community forest resource and the title in Annexure IV is provided to the Gram Sabha or the community.	Title receipt object; the case is not closed until the certified copy is uploaded and hash-sealed.
Rule 16	Post-claim support and handholding: government schemes for land improvement, productivity, basic amenities and livelihood must reach the rights holders.	Convergence register linking the recognised CFR to scheme applications; the hand-off point to the livelihood modules.
Sections 7 and 8	Contravention by an authority or officer is an offence; no court takes cognizance unless a sixty-day notice has been given to the SLMC and the SLMC has not proceeded.	Grievance module can generate the Section 8 notice with its sixty-day clock; this is the last-resort escalation path in the workflow tracker.

2.3 Ten binding constraints on the module

#	Constraint	Engineering expression
C1	The system never determines eligibility or approves a claim.	No <code>decision</code> field is writable by any VanMitra role; decisions are only ever <i>recorded</i> from an authority order document.
C2	Readiness is administrative, not legal.	The readiness indicator is labelled "documentation completeness" everywhere in the UI and never uses the words eligible, approved, valid or score.
C3	Satellite and GPS output is supplementary.	Geo evidence carries <code>is_substitutable = false</code> and cannot alone satisfy Rule 13(3).
C4	Digital records supplement, never replace, the signed paper record.	Every statutory artefact is generated as a printable document with a signature or thumb-impression block; the digital copy stores the scan of the signed original.
C5	Gram Sabha authority cannot be bypassed by a facilitator.	NGO roles have create and draft rights only; submission for resolution requires an FRC actor, and resolution requires the Gram Sabha actor.
C6	No committee below the Gram Sabha may decide a claim.	There is no block-level or beat-level decision role in the RBAC matrix at all.
C7	Limitation periods must never be lost silently.	Every adverse order starts a visible countdown with escalating notifications at day 30, 45, 55 and 58.
C8	Records are tamper-evident.	Evidence, meeting, resolution and workflow rows are append-only and hash-chained; corrections are new rows referencing the superseded row.

C9	Community data is not an open dataset.	Personal claimant data, precise boundary geometry and elder testimony are consent-scoped and are not exposed in any public API.
C10	The village must be able to work with no network for weeks.	Every claim-critical operation is available offline; only synchronisation and AI assistance require connectivity.

3 Authorities, Officers and Departments

The module models real offices, not abstract roles. Each institution below is a row in `authority_actor` with its designation, department and jurisdiction, so that generated letters carry the correct addressee, escalation goes to the correct level, and the case history shows which office is holding the file.

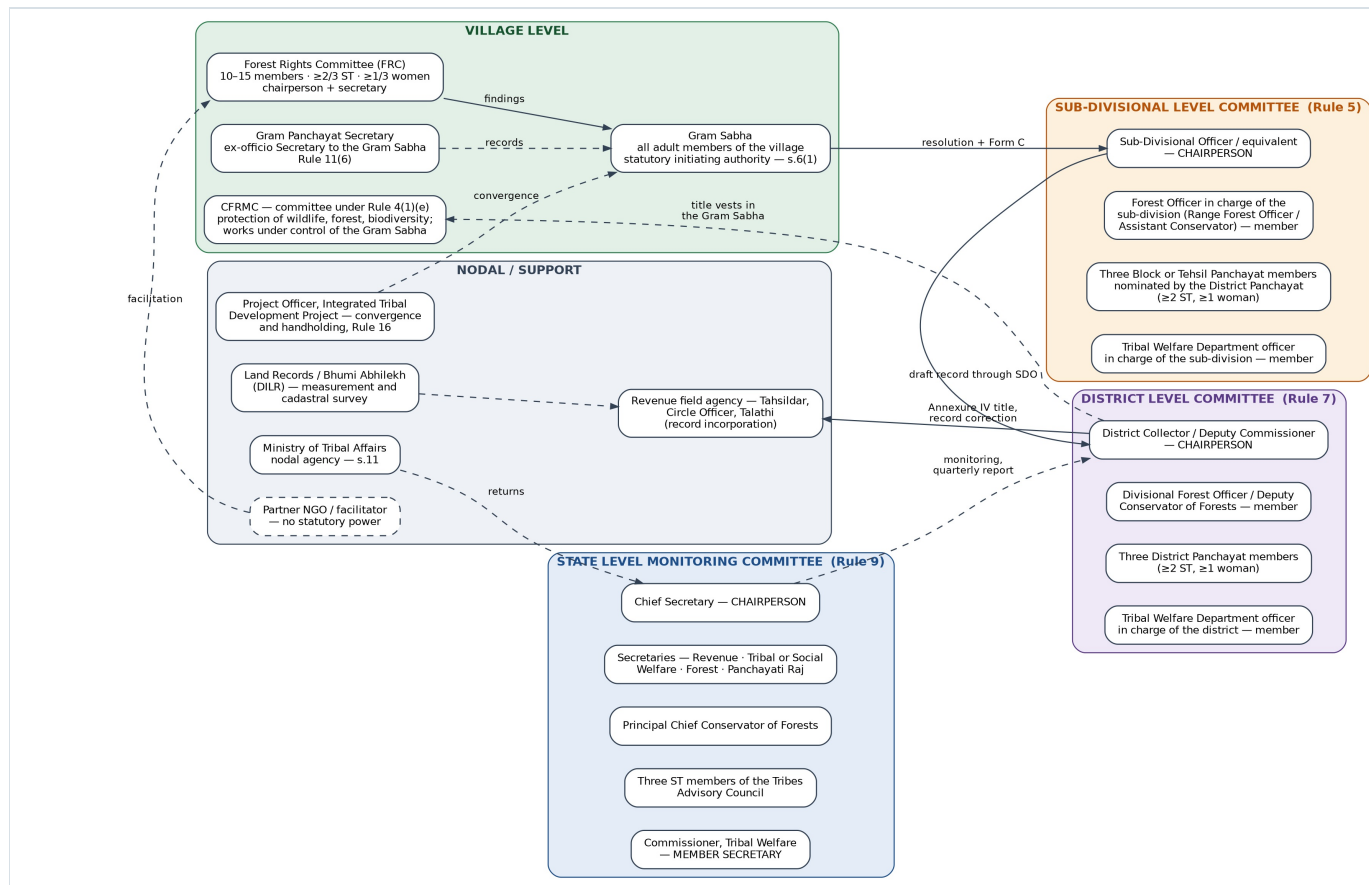


Figure 1 — Institutional map of the CFR claim: village institutions, the three statutory committees, the State-level monitoring body and the supporting revenue, land-record and tribal-development agencies. Solid arrows carry the file; dashed arrows carry records, monitoring or facilitation.

3.1 Village-level institutions

Institution / officer	Constitution	Function in the CFR claim	Statutory basis
Gram Sabha	All adult members of the village; in states without Panchayats, padas, tolas and traditional village institutions, with full and unrestricted participation of women.	Initiates determination of rights; receives, consolidates and verifies claims; approves the CFR map; passes the resolution; forwards to the SDLC; after recognition, holds the title and regulates access.	Section 2(g), Section 6(1), Section 5, Rule 4
Forest Rights Committee (FRC)	Elected by the Gram Sabha in its first meeting; 10 to 15 members; at least two-thirds Scheduled Tribes; not less than one-third women; a chairperson and a secretary intimated to the SDLC.	Receives and acknowledges claims; prepares the record of claims, evidence and maps; conducts the site visit and physical verification; delineates the customary boundary with elders; prepares Form C on behalf of the Gram Sabha; presents findings.	Rule 3, Rule 11(2)(3)(4), Rule 12(1)
Secretary, Gram Panchayat	Ex officio.	Acts as Secretary to the Gram Sabha in the discharge of its functions; custodian of the meeting record and resolution register.	Rule 11(6)
Committee under Rule 4(1)(e) — in practice the CFRMC	Constituted by the Gram Sabha from amongst its members.	Protection of wildlife, forest and biodiversity under Section 5; prepares the conservation and management plan for the community forest resource and integrates it with the working plan or micro plan of the forest department; operates under the control of the Gram Sabha.	Rule 4(1)(e)(f)(g); Guidelines iv(d)

Gram Panchayat	Elected body.	Convenes the Gram Sabha; prepares the list of hamlets and habitations for consolidation.	Rule 3(1), Rule 2A(a)
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3.2 Sub-Divisional Level Committee (SDLC)

Constituted by the State Government [Section 6(3), Rule 5]. This is the first statutory filter above the village and the committee the module addresses most often.

Member	Department	Position	Role in the claim
Sub-Divisional Officer or equivalent officer (in Maharashtra commonly the Sub-Divisional Officer / Prant Officer)	Revenue	Chairperson	Signs the forwarding of claims and the draft record to the DLC [Rule 6(j)]; presides over petition hearings [Rule 14].
Forest Officer in charge of the sub-division or equivalent (Range Forest Officer / Assistant Conservator of Forests, as designated)	Forest	Member	Supplies forest maps; participates in verification; departmental view on the CFR boundary.
Three members of the Block or Tehsil level Panchayats nominated by the District Panchayat — at least two Scheduled Tribes, preferably forest dwellers or from primitive tribal groups; at least one woman. In Sixth Schedule areas, three members nominated by the Autonomous District or Regional Council.	Panchayati Raj	Members	Community representation in examination of the veracity of claims.
Officer of the Tribal Welfare Department in charge of the sub-division, or where unavailable, the officer in charge of tribal affairs	Tribal / Social Welfare	Member	Awareness, proforma availability, protection of claimant interest [Rule 6(a)(k)(l)].

Functions the module tracks against the SDLC: providing forest and revenue maps and electoral rolls [6(b)]; collating resolutions [6(c)]; consolidating maps [6(d)]; examining veracity [6(e)]; hearing and adjudicating inter-Gram-Sabha disputes [6(f)]; hearing petitions including from State agencies [6(g)]; coordinating inter-sub-divisional claims [6(h)]; preparing the block or tehsil-wise draft record [6(i)]; forwarding to the DLC through the Sub-Divisional Officer [6(j)]; ensuring free availability of Forms A, B and C [6(l)]; ensuring Gram Sabha meetings are free, open, fair and with requisite quorum [6(m)].

3.3 District Level Committee (DLC)

Constituted by the State Government [Section 6(5), Rule 7]. Its decision on the record of forest rights is **final and binding** [Section 6(6)].

Member	Department	Position	Role in the claim
District Collector or Deputy Commissioner	Revenue / District Administration	Chairperson	Final approval of claims and the record of forest rights; signs the Annexure IV title; directs correction of government records [Rule 8(c)(f), Rule 15(6)].
Divisional Forest Officer or Deputy Conservator of Forests	Forest	Member	Signs the Annexure IV title; responsible with Revenue for the final map and record incorporation [Annexure IV; Rule 12A(9)].
Three members of the District Panchayat nominated by the District Panchayat — at least two Scheduled Tribes, at least one woman; or three nominees of the Autonomous District / Regional Council in Sixth Schedule areas	Panchayati Raj	Members	Community representation in final approval.
Officer of the Tribal Welfare Department in charge of the district, or the officer in charge of tribal affairs	Tribal / Social Welfare	Member	Signs the title as District Tribal Welfare Officer; ensures PVTG habitat and pastoralist claims are filed [Rule 12B(1)(2)].
Secretary of the District Level Committee	As designated	Secretary	Records the reasons where no community forest resource right is recognised in a village [Rule 12B(4)].

3.4 State Level Monitoring Committee (SLMC)

Constituted under [Section 6(7), Rule 9]; the escalation and grievance body for the module.

Member	Position	Relevance to the claim module
Chief Secretary	Chairperson	Signs the quarterly return in Annexure V.

Secretary, Revenue Department	Member	Record updation compliance.
Secretary, Tribal or Social Welfare Department	Member	Claim quality and rejection reasons.
Secretary, Forest Department	Member	Forest-side compliance, transit and MFP policy alignment.
Secretary, Panchayati Raj	Member	Gram Sabha functioning and quorum compliance.
Principal Chief Conservator of Forests	Member	Working plan integration with CFR management plans.
Three Scheduled Tribes members of the Tribes Advisory Council, nominated by its Chairperson	Members	Community oversight.
Commissioner, Tribal Welfare or equivalent	Member Secretary	Recipient of the Section 8 sixty-day notice; convenes the quarterly meeting.

Module hooks: the SLMC must meet at least once in three months and furnish a quarterly report in the format of Annexure V covering claims filed, accepted, rejected and pending, reasons for rejection with examples, corrective measures, extent of forest land covered, status of record updation and details of the community forest resource being managed and by whom [Rule 10(c)]. The module produces exactly this shape of data, so a district or NGO federation can populate the return without re-keying.

3.5 Nodal, revenue and land-record agencies

Agency / officer	Department	Why the module needs it
Ministry of Tribal Affairs	Government of India	Nodal agency for implementation of the Act [Section 11]; issuer of the Guidelines; recipient of the quarterly returns.
State Tribal Development Department / Commissionerate of Tribal Development	Tribal Development	State nodal agency; training plans for revenue, forest and tribal welfare field staff, FRCs and Panchayat representatives [Guidelines vi(b)].
Project Officer, Integrated Tribal Development Project (ITDP)	Tribal Development	The practical district-level coordination point for awareness camps, claim camps and post-claim convergence under Rule 16 in tribal sub-plan areas.
Tahsildar / Circle Officer / Talathi	Revenue	Village-level revenue record incorporation after the title; supply of 7/12, gaonthan, gochar and other village records used as Rule 13 evidence.
District Inspector of Land Records (DILR) / Superintendent of Land Records; Bhumi Abhilekh (Directorate of Land Records)	Settlement and Land Records	Official measurement and cadastral survey where the title is issued but boundaries remain unmeasured; the addressee of the survey request generated by the module.
Range Forest Officer, Round Officer, Beat Guard	Forest	Field presence during verification; compartment and working-plan records; the department whose absence must be formally recorded under Rule 12A(1)(2).
Partner NGO / community-based organisation	Non-statutory	Facilitation, documentation support, capacity building. Explicitly holds no statutory power and is modelled with draft-only rights.

Verification note. Designations at sub-divisional level vary between States and, within a State, between scheduled and non-scheduled districts; some States also notify additional members or a different Tribal Welfare designation. The `authority_actor` table is therefore configuration, not code. Before pilot go-live, the district register must be populated from the current State Government notification and the relevant Government Resolutions, and re-verified at every transfer season.

3.6 System roles mapped to statutory roles

System role	Held by	Can do	Cannot do
<code>community_member</code>	Adult village member	View own and village claim status, upload own documents with assistance, view awareness content, view Gram Sabha records that are published.	Edit a claim, view another household's personal documents, see precise boundary coordinates.
<code>ngo_facilitator</code>	Trained NGO field worker	Onboard villages, create draft cases, capture evidence and GPS, prepare meeting papers, run the readiness checklist, generate letters.	Sign a verification, record a resolution, mark a claim submitted, alter a signed artefact.
<code>frc_member</code>	Elected FRC member	Acknowledge claims, verify evidence, conduct the site visit, delineate the boundary, author Form C, record findings.	Verify a claim in which the member is a claimant [Rule 3(3)]; pass a resolution.
<code>frc_chair / frc_secretary</code>	FRC office bearers	Sign the findings and the Form C packet; correspond with the SDLC.	Decide a claim.
<code>gs_secretary</code>	Gram Panchayat Secretary	Create meetings, record attendance and quorum, record and publish resolutions.	Alter evidence or verification records.
<code>cfrmc_member</code>	Rule 4(1)(e) committee	Post-title management plan, resource register, monitoring responses.	Anything in the pre-title claim workflow.
<code>authority_viewer</code>	SDLC / DLC / SLMC officer, where authorised	Read the submitted packet, download the evidence bundle, record an	Edit community data; the module never becomes the official file of record.

		acknowledgement.	
admin	Implementation team	Configure districts, actors, master data, releases.	Edit case content or ledger rows.

4 Documents, Forms and Evidence Required

The document set falls into four buckets, and the module treats them very differently. Bucket 1 is the statutory claim form. Bucket 2 is the evidence the community brings. Bucket 3 is the procedural record the module itself generates and prints for signature. Bucket 4 is what comes back from the authorities. Only buckets 1 and 3 are produced by VanMitra; buckets 2 and 4 are captured.

4.1 Bucket 1 — Form C, the CFR claim form

Form C, *Claim Form for Rights to Community Forest Resource*, was inserted into the Rules by the 2012 Amendment [See Section 3(1)(i) of the Act and Rule 11(1) and 4(a)]. Its fields map one-to-one to the module's data model.

#	Form C field	Data model location	Capture behaviour and validation
1	Village / Gram Sabha	village.name, gram_sabha.gs_id	Selected from the village registry, pre-filled from the LGD code; hamlets appear with their parent village and consolidation status [Rule 2A].
2	Gram Panchayat	village.gram_panchayat	Master data; not free text.
3	Tehsil / Taluka	village.taluka	Drives the SDLC jurisdiction lookup.
4	District	village.district	Drives the DLC jurisdiction lookup.
5	Names of members of the Gram Sabha, attached as a separate sheet with ST / OTFD status against each member. The Form records that the presence of a few Scheduled Tribes or Other Traditional Forest Dwellers is sufficient to make the claim.	gs_member roster with category	Generated as the annexed member sheet with the status column; also feeds the quorum calculator so the roster is maintained once and used twice.
5a	The resolving statement — that the area detailed and shown in the attached map comprises the community forest resource over which recognition under Section 3(1)(i) is claimed	resolution.decision_text	Standard clause pre-loaded in Marathi, Hindi and English, editable by the FRC.
5b	Attached map of the community forest resource showing location and landmarks within the traditional or customary boundaries, or the seasonal use of landscape for pastoral communities. The Form expressly notes this need not correspond to existing legal boundaries.	cfr_boundary.geom + generated map sheet	Produced by the geospatial pipeline in section 6.4; printed at a legible scale with a landmark table and a north arrow. The module never coerces the polygon to a cadastral or compartment boundary.
6	Khasra / compartment numbers, if any and if known	cfr_boundary.parcel_refs[]	Optional by design — the form says "if any and if known". The UI must not present it as mandatory.
7	Bordering villages (i, ii, iii ...), which may include information on sharing of resources and responsibilities with other villages	cfr_adjacency	Pre-populated from polygon adjacency, confirmed by the community, and cross-checked against the Rule 11(1)(b) intimation register.
8	List of evidence in support [see Rule 13]	evidence ledger	Printed as a numbered schedule with the rule sub-clause against each item, which is what the SDLC and DLC read first.
9	Signature / thumb impression of the claimant(s)	Scan of the signed original	The printed packet carries the block; the signed sheet is scanned back in and hash-sealed. The digital record alone is never treated as the claim.

4.2 Bucket 2A — General evidence under Rule 13(1)

Rule 13(1) lists the evidence for recognition and vesting of forest rights. At least two of these must accompany the claim [Rule 11(1)(a)], and the committees must consider more than one [Rule 13(3)]. The module tags every captured artefact with its sub-clause.

Rule	Evidence category	How the module captures it
13(1)(a)	Public documents and Government records — gazetteers, census, survey and settlement reports, maps, satellite imagery, working plans, management plans, micro-plans, forest enquiry reports, other forest records, record of rights by whatever name called, pattas or leases, reports of committees and commissions, Government orders, notifications, circulars, resolutions.	Scan-and-tag with a source field (issuing office, reference number, date). Requests for authenticated copies are generated under Rule 12(4) and tracked.
13(1)(b)	Government authorised documents — voter	Captured with OCR field extraction; personal identifiers are consent-scoped and

	identity card, ration card, passport, house tax receipts, domicile certificates.	masked in shared exports.
13(1)(c)	Physical attributes — houses, huts and permanent improvements including levelling, bunds, check dams and the like.	Geotagged photograph with a bearing and a short description; grouped into a photo plate in the packet.
13(1)(d)	Quasi-judicial and judicial records, including court orders and judgments.	Scan with case number, forum and date; often decisive in disputed-boundary cases.
13(1)(e)	Research studies and documentation of customs and traditions illustrating the enjoyment of forest rights and having the force of customary law, by reputed institutions such as the Anthropological Survey of India.	Bibliographic record plus the relevant extract; NGO and academic partners contribute here.
13(1)(f)	Any record including maps, record of rights, privileges, concessions and favours from erstwhile princely States, provinces or other intermediaries.	Archive scan with provenance note.
13(1)(g)	Traditional structures establishing antiquity — wells, burial grounds, sacred places.	Geotagged waypoint plus photograph; these points are also landmarks on the CFR map, so one field action produces two artefacts.
13(1)(h)	Genealogy tracing ancestry to individuals named in earlier land records or recognised as legitimate residents at an earlier time.	Structured family-tree entry linked to the cited record.
13(1)(i)	Statement of elders other than claimants, reduced in writing.	Voice capture with speech-to-text; the transcript is printed, read back, corrected and signed or thumb-marked — the signed sheet is the evidence, the audio is the supporting record. The module blocks a statement recorded from a person who is himself a claimant in the same case.

4.3 Bucket 2B — Community forest resource evidence under Rule 13(2)

These are the evidences specific to the CFR claim and are what distinguishes a Form C bundle from a Form B bundle. A CFR claim with no Rule 13(2) evidence is not a CFR claim.

Rule	Evidence category	Field capture design
13(2)(a)	Community rights such as <i>nistari</i> , by whatever name called.	Records of nistari rights, khatian-type entries or their State equivalents; the DLC is separately required to make prior recorded nistari records available [<i>Guidelines iii(a)</i>].
13(2)(b)	Traditional grazing grounds; areas for collection of roots and tubers, fodder, wild edible fruits and other minor forest produce; fishing grounds; irrigation systems; sources of water for human or livestock use; medicinal plant collection territories of herbal practitioners.	Captured as a use-zone layer : each use type is a named polygon or point cluster inside the CFR boundary, with the season of use and the households or hamlets that use it. This layer is the strongest single body of evidence in most claims and doubles as the base for the later management plan.
13(2)(c)	Remnants of structures built by the local community, sacred trees, groves and ponds or riverine areas, burial or cremation grounds.	Geotagged waypoints with photographs; automatically promoted to map landmarks under Rule 12(1)(g).
13(2)(d)	Government records or earlier classification of current reserve forest as protected forest, or as <i>gochar</i> or other village common lands, or <i>nistari</i> forests.	Archival record request to the Forest and Revenue departments, tracked as a dependency on the case.
13(2)(e)	Earlier or current practice of traditional agriculture.	Field observation record plus elder statement; season-tagged.

What the committees may not do with evidence. They may not insist on any particular form of documentary evidence. Fine receipts, encroacher lists, primary offence reports, forest settlement reports and similar documentation arising from prior official exercises — or the absence of such documentation — cannot be the sole basis for rejecting a claim. Satellite imagery and other technology may supplement other evidence and shall not be treated as a replacement [*Rule 12A(11), Explanations 1 and 2; Guidelines i(g)(h)*]. The module surfaces these three sentences on the rejection-recording screen, because they are the most frequently used grounds of appeal.

4.4 Bucket 3 — Procedural records generated by the module

Each of these is produced as a print-ready document in the local language with a signature or thumb-impression block, and each is stored back as a scanned, hash-sealed artefact.

#	Generated document	Basis	Contents and purpose
G1	Notice calling for claims and fixing the CFR determination date	Rule 11(1)(a)(b)	Date of calling, three-month window, place of filing, list of acceptable evidence. Displayed at the customary public place and recorded with the date of display.

G2	Intimation to adjoining Gram Sabhas and to the SDLC	Rule 11(1)(b)	Names the adjoining villages proposed by polygon adjacency, the date fixed, and requests attendance at the boundary walk. Dispatch date recorded.
G3	FRC constitution certificate	Rule 3(1)(2)	Member list with ST status and gender, arithmetic proof of the two-thirds and one-third requirements, chairperson and secretary, and the intimation to the SDLC.
G4	Claim acknowledgement receipt	Rule 11(3)	Serial number, date, claimant or Gram Sabha, claim type, list of documents received.
G5	Request for forest and revenue maps and electoral rolls	Rule 6(b)	Addressed to the SDLC; tracked with a reminder clock.
G6	Request for authenticated copies of records	Rule 12(4)	Addressed to the record-holding office, listing the specific records sought.
G7	Intimation of the site visit to the claimant and the Forest Department	Rule 12(1)	Date, time, meeting point, expected participants.
G8	Field verification proceeding sheet	Rule 12(1)(a)–(e), 12A(1)	Observations, evidence seen on site, participants present, and a signature block for the Forest and Revenue officials with designation, date and comments. Where an official does not attend, the sheet records the absence and the intimation reference — this is what protects the claim under Rule 12A(2).
G9	Participatory boundary delineation record	Rule 12(1)(f)	Named elders and members who walked the boundary, the described segments, landmarks per segment, and the date.
G10	CFR map sheet	Rule 12(1)(g)	Boundary, landmarks with a numbered legend, bordering villages, use zones, scale, north arrow and the Gram Sabha resolution reference. Annexed to Form C.
G11	Gram Sabha meeting notice and agenda	Rule 4, 11(5)	Prior notice with the agenda item naming the CFR claim.
G12	Attendance and quorum sheet	Rule 4(2)	Registered members, present, women present, claimants or representatives present, and the computed satisfaction of each of the three tests.
G13	Gram Sabha resolution	Section 6(1); Rule 12(1)(g)	Resolution number, date, agenda, discussion, decision, votes for and against, approval of the Form C claim and the annexed map, and the direction to forward to the SDLC.
G14	FRC findings report	Rule 12(2)	Nature and extent of the claim as verified, evidence relied upon, and the recommendation placed before the Gram Sabha.
G15	Submission covering letter and index	Rule 11(5)	Forwarding letter to the SDLC with a page-numbered index of the entire packet, produced so that the receiving clerk can acknowledge page counts.
G16	Petition to the SDLC or DLC	Rules 14, 15; Rule 12A(3)	Pre-drafted from the adverse order: grounds, the date of personal communication, the limitation calculation, and the relief sought.
G17	Joint meeting record for conflicting claims	Rule 12(3); Rule 14(7)	Participating Gram Sabhas and FRCs, the nature of enjoyment considered, and the agreed or disagreed outcome.
G18	Survey and measurement request	Practice; supports Rule 12A(9)	Addressed to the land-record authority where a title exists but measurement does not; includes the title reference and the mapped extent.
G19	Section 8 notice to the SLMC	Section 8; Guidelines vi(d)	Sixty-day notice of contravention, used only after ordinary remedies are exhausted.
G20	Case file export (complete bundle)	Facilitation	A single indexed PDF of the entire case for the Gram Sabha's own record and for handover to authorities.

4.5 Bucket 4 — Documents received from authorities

Document	From	Basis	Effect in the module
Receipt / acknowledgement of the claim packet	SDLC office	Practice	Moves the case to SUBMITTED_SDLC and starts the tracking clock.
Forest and revenue maps, electoral rolls	SDLC	Rule 6(b)	Clears a blocking dependency; the maps become reference layers.
Draft record of proposed forest rights	SDLC	Rule 6(i)(j)	Recorded as the artefact forwarded to the DLC.
Order of modification, rejection or remand	SDLC or DLC	Rule 12A(3)(6)(7) (10)	Starts the limitation clock from the date of personal communication; triggers the appeal draft; the presence or absence of recorded reasons is captured as a field.
Title to Community Forest Resources — Annexure IV	DLC	Rule 8(i)	The recognition event. Fields: village / Gram Sabha, Gram Panchayat, tehsil, district, whether ST community, OTFD community or both, and the description of boundaries including customary boundary, prominent landmarks and khasra or compartment numbers. Signed by the Divisional

			Forest Officer or Deputy Conservator of Forests, the District Tribal Welfare Officer and the District Collector or Deputy Commissioner.
Certified copy of the record of the right	DLC	Rule 8(i)	Required before the case may close.
Final map of vested forest land; record incorporation entry	Revenue and Forest Departments	Rule 12A(9)	Moves the case to <code>RECORD_UPDATED</code> ; until then the case is recognised but incomplete.

4.6 The evidence sufficiency engine

The single most valuable computation in the module is not artificial intelligence; it is a deterministic rule check that tells a village, before the Gram Sabha meets, whether its bundle satisfies the tests the committees will apply.

```

SUFFICIENCY(case) :
R1 count(evidence where rule_ref like '13(1)%' and verified) >= 2           # Rule 11(1)(a), 13(3)
R2 count(evidence where rule_ref like '13(2)%' and verified) >= 1           # CFR-specific character
R3 exists(boundary where status = 'GS_APPROVED')                           # Rule 12(1)(g)
R4 count(landmarks on boundary) >= 1 per boundary segment                  # Rule 12(1)(g)
R5 exists(verification_proceeding with forest_signed or forest_absence_recorded)
    and (revenue_signed or revenue_absence_recorded)                        # Rule 12A(1)(2)
R6 exists(elder_statement signed) OR count(13(1) evidence) >= 3            # Rule 13(1)(i)
R7 quorum_test(meeting) = PASS                                             # Rule 4(2)
R8 adjoining_intimation_sent for every adjacent gram_sabha                 # Rule 11(1)(b)
R9 acknowledgement_issued                                                  # Rule 11(3)
R10 no unresolved overlap OR joint_meeting_record exists                   # Rule 12(3)

readiness = "COMPLETE" if all(R1..R10) else list of unmet items, each with
    its rule citation and a one-line instruction in the local language

```

Wording discipline. The output of this engine is displayed as "*documentation completeness: 8 of 10 items*" with the missing items named. It is never displayed as a percentage likelihood of approval, a score, or an eligibility statement. A claim that fails a check is still a valid claim that the Gram Sabha may resolve to forward; the engine advises, it does not gate. The only hard blocks in the system are the quorum test and the signature requirements, because those are procedural validity conditions rather than evidentiary judgements.

5 The CFR Claim Procedure — Stage-by-Stage Workflow

The procedure below is the statutory sequence, with the module's actions inserted at each step. Figures 3a and 3b show the same sequence graphically. Stage numbers correspond to the states of the claim state machine in section 6.2.

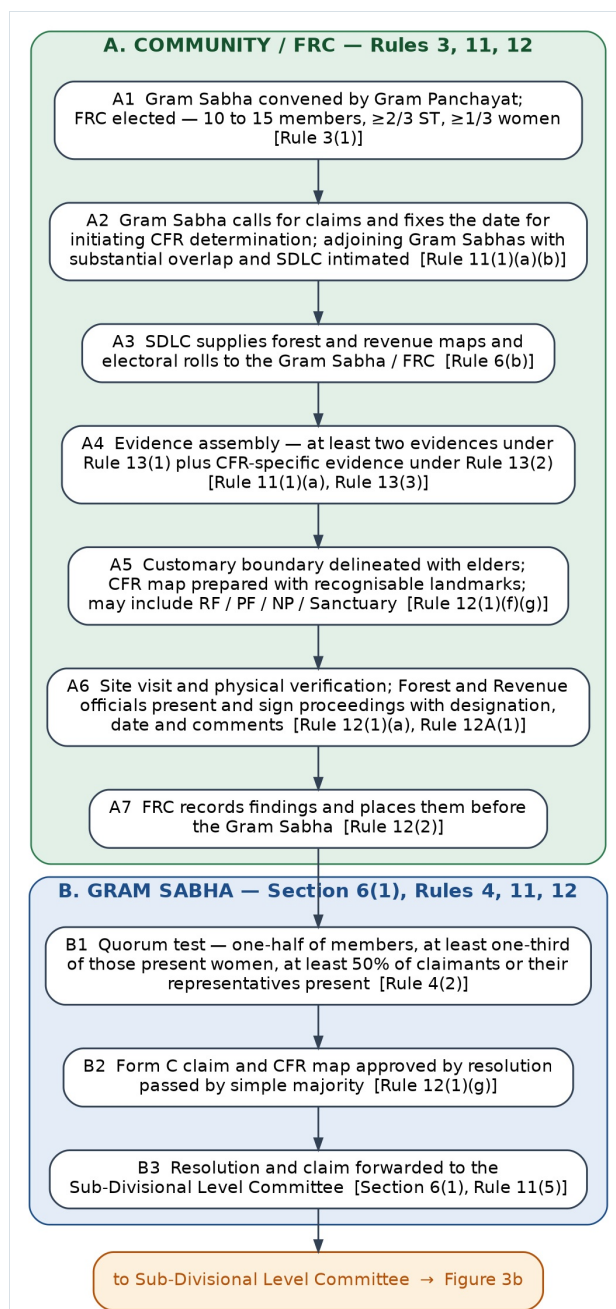


Figure 2a — Village-level statutory workflow: constitution of the FRC through the Gram Sabha resolution. Each box carries its governing rule.

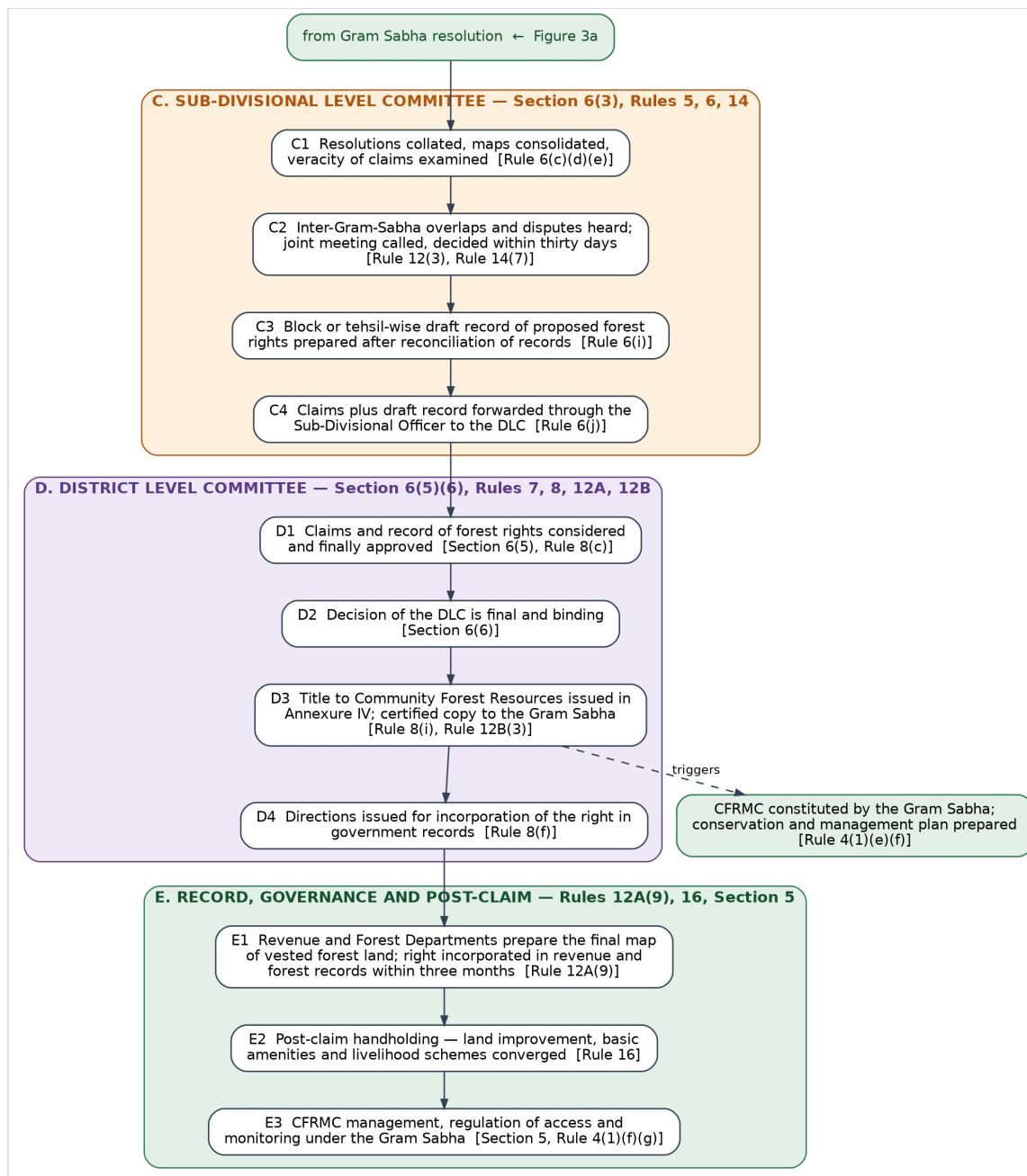


Figure 2b — Statutory workflow above the village: Sub-Divisional Level Committee, District Level Committee, record incorporation and the transition into community forest management.

5.1 Stage table

Stage	Owner	Statutory content	Module actions	Exit criteria
0 Preparation	NGO facilitator; Gram Panchayat	Awareness of the Act and of the CFR right; identification of hamlets and habitations for consolidation <i>[Rule 2A]</i> .	Village registry entry created with LGD code, households, forest dependency and existing FRA status; hamlet hierarchy recorded; awareness sessions logged with participation and women's participation.	Village profile complete; community indicates intent to claim.
1 FRC constitution	Gram Sabha	Gram Sabha convened by the Gram Panchayat; FRC of 10-15 elected in the first meeting, at least two-thirds ST and not less than one-third women; chairperson and secretary intimated to the SDLC <i>[Rule 3]</i> .	Composition validator; generation of G3 constitution certificate and the SDLC intimation; conflict-of-interest flags set for members who are themselves claimants <i>[Rule 3(3)]</i> .	Valid FRC recorded and intimation dispatched.
2 Calling of claims	Gram Sabha	Claims called for and the FRC authorised to accept them in the prescribed Forms; three-month window, extendable with written reasons; a date fixed for initiating CFR determination and adjoining Gram Sabhas with substantial overlaps and the SDLC intimated <i>[Rule 11(1)(a)(b)]</i> .	G1 notice and G2 intimations generated; three-month timer started; adjacency suggestion from the geo service; G5 request for forest and revenue maps raised under Rule 6(b).	Notice displayed and dated; intimations dispatched; window open.
3 Claim registration	FRC	Claims received, acknowledged in writing and retained with supporting evidence; a record of claims and evidence including maps prepared; a list of claimants prepared <i>[Rule 11(2)(3)]</i> .	Case created as <code>claim_type = CFR</code> ; G4 acknowledgement printed; evidence ledger opened; offline capture available throughout.	Case exists with an acknowledgement number.
4 Evidence assembly	FRC with NGO support	At least two Rule 13(1) evidences; CFR-specific evidence under Rule 13(2); statements of elders reduced to writing <i>[Rule 11(1)(a), 13]</i> .	Tagged capture against every sub-clause; OCR and speech-to-text assistance; duplicate detection; G6 record requests where documents are held by an office; the sufficiency engine reports gaps in the local language.	R1 and R2 of the sufficiency engine satisfied, or a conscious Gram Sabha decision to proceed.
5 Boundary delineation	FRC with elders	Customary boundaries delineated with Gram Sabha members including elders well versed with those boundaries and customary access <i>[Rule 12(1)(f)]</i> .	Boundary walk with GPS trace and waypoints; named participants recorded in G9; landmarks captured with photographs; use zones drawn for Rule 13(2)(b).	Draft polygon closed and topologically valid.
6 Overlap reconciliation	FRCs of the concerned Gram Sabhas	Conflicting claims about customary boundaries, or a forest area used by more than one Gram Sabha, considered in a joint meeting of the respective FRCs; findings submitted in writing; unresolved conflicts referred to the SDLC <i>[Rule 12(3)]</i> .	PostGIS intersection test against neighbouring polygons; if an overlap exists the case enters <code>DISPUTE</code> ; G17 joint meeting record generated; referral packet if unresolved.	No unresolved overlap, or an SDLC referral on record.
7 Field verification	FRC with Forest and Revenue officials	Site visit after due intimation to the claimant and the Forest Department; physical verification of nature, extent and evidence on site; further evidence received; pastoralist, nomadic and PVTG claims verified in the presence of those communities; officials of the Forest and Revenue departments remain present and sign the proceedings with designation, date and comments <i>[Rule 12(1)(a)-(e), 12A(1)]</i> .	G7 intimation with a dispatch record; offline verification form; presence register; G8 proceeding sheet with departmental signature blocks; where an official is absent, the absence and the intimation reference are recorded so that Rule 12A(2) can be invoked.	Signed proceeding sheet, or a formally recorded absence.
8 Findings and map approval	FRC → Gram Sabha	The FRC records its findings and presents them to the Gram Sabha; a CFR map with recognisable landmarks and substantial Rule 13(2) evidence is prepared; the claim is approved by a resolution passed by simple majority <i>[Rule 12(1)(g), 12(2)]</i> .	G14 findings report; G10 map sheet rendered at scale; readiness summary presented as an agenda annexure.	Findings placed before the Gram Sabha.
9 Gram Sabha resolution	Gram Sabha	Meeting with prior notice; quorum of one-half of members, at least one-third of those present women, at least fifty per cent of claimants or representatives present where claim resolutions are passed; simple majority of those present and voting; resolution forwarded to the SDLC <i>[Rule 4(2), 11(5); Section 6(1)]</i> .	G11 notice; G12 attendance and quorum sheet with the three arithmetic tests computed live; G13 resolution; hash-chained record; the workflow refuses to advance if quorum fails.	Resolution passed and recorded with quorum proof.

10 Submission	FRC / Gram Sabha Secretary	Resolution with the claim and the map forwarded to the SDLC [Section 6(1), Rule 11(5)].	G15 covering letter and page-numbered index; complete packet printed and exported; acknowledgement from the SDLC office scanned back in; submission date recorded.	Packet delivered and acknowledgement captured.
11 SDLC examination	Sub-Divisional Level Committee	Resolutions collated, maps consolidated, veracity examined; inter-Gram-Sabha disputes heard; petitions heard; block or tehsil-wise draft record prepared after reconciliation of government records; forwarded through the Sub-Divisional Officer to the DLC [Rule 6(c)-(j)].	Status tracking with a follow-up cadence; hearing notices logged (at least fifteen days before the hearing date under Rule 14(2)); remand handled as a first-class state; any adverse recommendation captured with its recorded reasons.	Draft record forwarded to the DLC, or a petition path opened.
12 DLC decision	District Level Committee	Claims and record considered and finally approved; the decision is final and binding; where the DLC does not accept the Gram Sabha or SDLC recommendation it records detailed reasons in writing and supplies a copy of the order; CFR rights ensured in all villages with forest dwellers and titles issued [Section 6(5)(6), Rule 8(c), 12A(7), 12B(3)].	Order capture; if adverse, the sixty-day limitation clock starts from the recorded date of personal communication [Rule 12A(3)] and G16 petition is drafted; if approved, the Annexure IV title is captured and the case moves to <code>TITLE_APPROVED</code> .	Title issued, or an order recorded with an active appeal.
13 Title and record	DLC; Revenue and Forest Departments	Certified copy of the record of the right and the Annexure IV title provided to the Gram Sabha; final map of vested forest land prepared; the right incorporated in revenue and forest records within the State record-updation cycle or three months, whichever is earlier [Rule 8(i), 12A(9)].	Title artefact hash-sealed; boundary version locked as the title polygon; three-month record clock; G18 survey request where measurement is pending; record incorporation evidence slot.	<code>RECORD_UPDATED</code> with the incorporation entry attached.
14 Post-recognition	Gram Sabha; CFRMC	Committee under Rule 4(1)(e) constituted; conservation and management plan prepared and integrated with the working or micro plan; transit permit, income and plan decisions approved by the Gram Sabha; the community protects wildlife, forest and biodiversity and regulates access [Section 5, Rule 4(1)(e)(f)(g)]; post-claim handholding and scheme convergence [Rule 16].	CFRMC module unlocked; management plan stored against a resolution; change-detection alerts phrased as "field verification recommended"; convergence register opened.	Continuous operation; the claim module hands over to the governance and livelihood modules.

5.2 Statutory clocks the module must run

Clock	Duration	Starts from	Behaviour in the module
Claim filing window [Rule 11(1)(a)]	3 months	Date of calling of claims	Countdown on the village dashboard; an extension requires a recorded written reason and a resolution reference.
Petition against a Gram Sabha resolution [Section 6(2), Rule 14(1)]	60 days	Date of the resolution	Visible to the Gram Sabha so that an aggrieved person's window is not overlooked.
Petition against an SDLC decision [Section 6(4), Rule 15(1)]	60 days	Date of the SDLC decision	Alerts at day 30, 45, 55 and 58; a draft petition is prepared automatically.
Petition after modification or rejection [Rule 12A(3)]	60 days, extendable by 30 at the committee's discretion	Date of communication in person to the claimant	The module stores the communication date separately from the order date, because the limitation runs from communication.
Notice of hearing before SDLC or DLC [Rules 14(2), 15(2)]	At least 15 days before the hearing	Date of the hearing	Recorded on receipt; a shorter notice is flagged as a procedural irregularity.
Gram Sabha meeting on a reference back [Rule 14(4)]	Within 30 days	Receipt of the reference	Meeting scheduling assistance and reminders.
Resolution of an inter-Gram-Sabha dispute [Rule 14(7)]	30 days for a mutually agreed solution	Joint meeting called	After 30 days the case shows the SDLC as the deciding authority.
Record updation after title [Rule 12A(9)]	State cycle or 3 months, whichever is	Issue of title	Open item on the district dashboard until the incorporation entry is captured.

	earlier		
SLMC quarterly return [Rule 10(c)]	Every 3 months	Rolling	Annexure V shaped export.
Section 8 notice before cognizance [Section 8]	60 days	Service of notice on the SLMC	Escalation path of last resort; tracked but never initiated automatically.

5.3 Adverse outcomes and how the module responds

Situation	Governing provision	Module response
Resolution found incomplete or prima facie requiring further examination	Rule 12A(6)	State <code>REMANDED_TO_GS</code> ; a re-verification checklist is generated listing only what the committee questioned; the original evidence is preserved unchanged.
Forest or Revenue department objects later, having been absent at verification	Rule 12A(2)	Re-verification is scheduled and re-intimated. If the department is absent a second time, the module prints the note that the Gram Sabha's decision on field verification is final, with the two intimation references.
Rejection or modification on technical or procedural grounds	Rule 12A(10); Guidelines i(f)(g)	Flagged as an appeal ground; the petition draft cites the prohibition on rejection on merely technical grounds and the requirement of a speaking order.
Rejection despite two or more Rule 13 evidences and a Gram Sabha recommendation, without written reasons	Guidelines i(g)	The sufficiency record is exported as the annexure to the petition, showing exactly which evidences were on file at the time of the decision.
Rejection based only on absence of fine receipts, encroacher lists or offence reports	Rule 12A(11) Explanation 1	Named ground in the petition template.
Rejection based only on satellite imagery	Rule 12A(11) Explanation 2; Guidelines i(h)	Named ground; the module's own geo layers are marked non-substitutable precisely so they cannot be misused this way.
Title issued but boundary never measured	Implementation practice; supports Rule 12A(9)	Sub-state <code>SURVEY_PENDING</code> ; G18 request to the land-record authority with follow-up tracking; the case remains visibly open.
No CFR right recognised in a village that has forest dwellers	Rule 12B(3)(4)	District coverage report lists the village as an omission and records whether the DLC Secretary's reasons have been furnished.
Contravention by an authority or officer	Sections 7, 8; Guidelines vi(d)	G19 Section 8 notice with its sixty-day clock and an inquiry-outcome field.

6 Claim Module Architecture

6.1 Layered architecture

The module is organised in five layers. The separation is not merely technical: layer 3 is isolated so that assistive intelligence can be disabled entirely without affecting the legal workflow, and layer 5 is isolated so that every interaction with a statutory authority passes through an explicit, auditable channel rather than being scattered through the codebase.

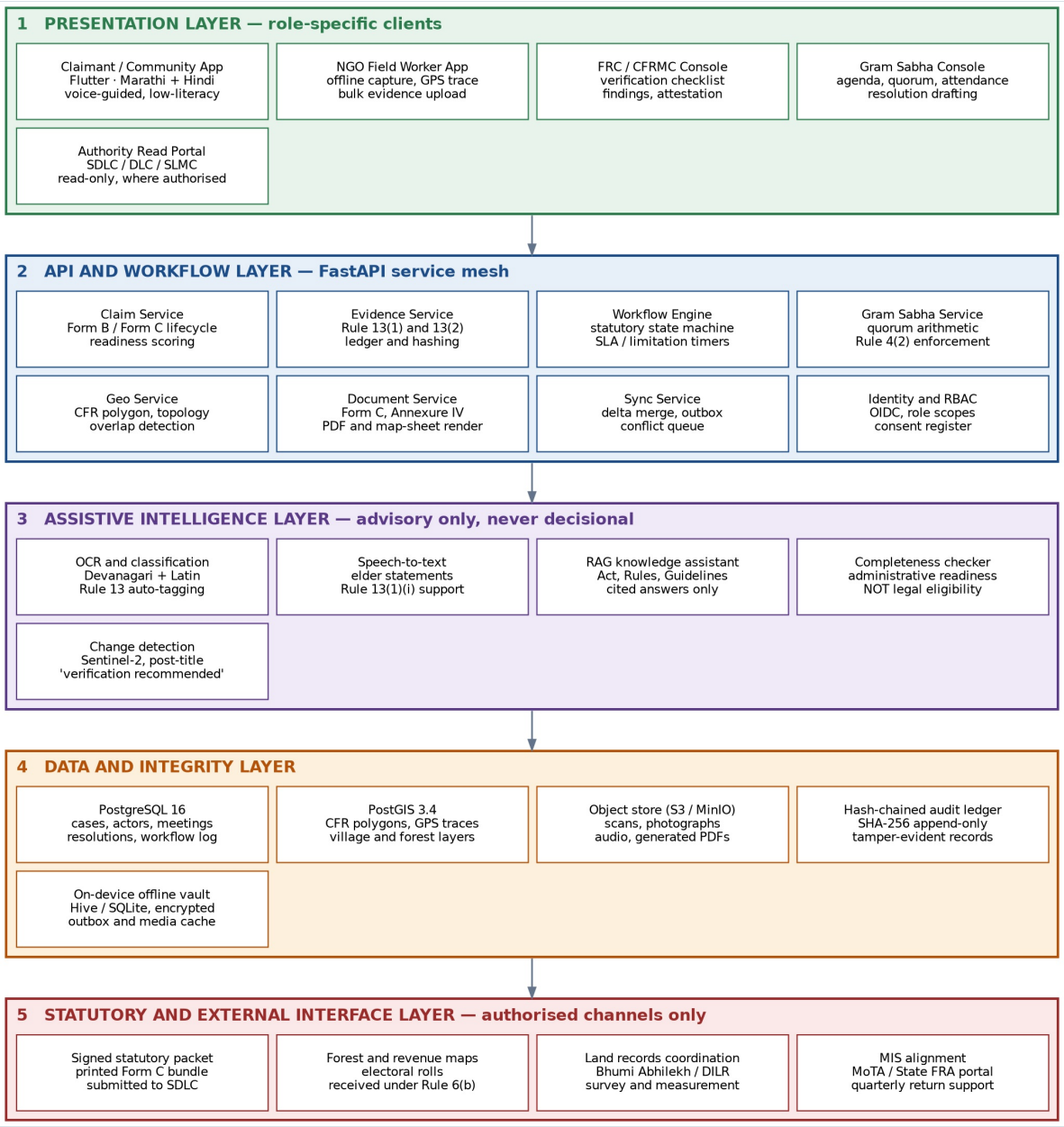


Figure 3 — Layered architecture of the CFR claim module. Layer 3 is advisory and removable; layer 5 contains every point at which the module touches a statutory process.

6.2 Claim state machine

The workflow engine is an explicit state machine rather than a set of boolean flags, because the statutory process has legitimate backward transitions — remand, re-verification, petition — that flag-based designs handle badly. Every transition writes a `workflow_event` row carrying the acting authority, the order reference, the reason text and the resulting statutory clock.

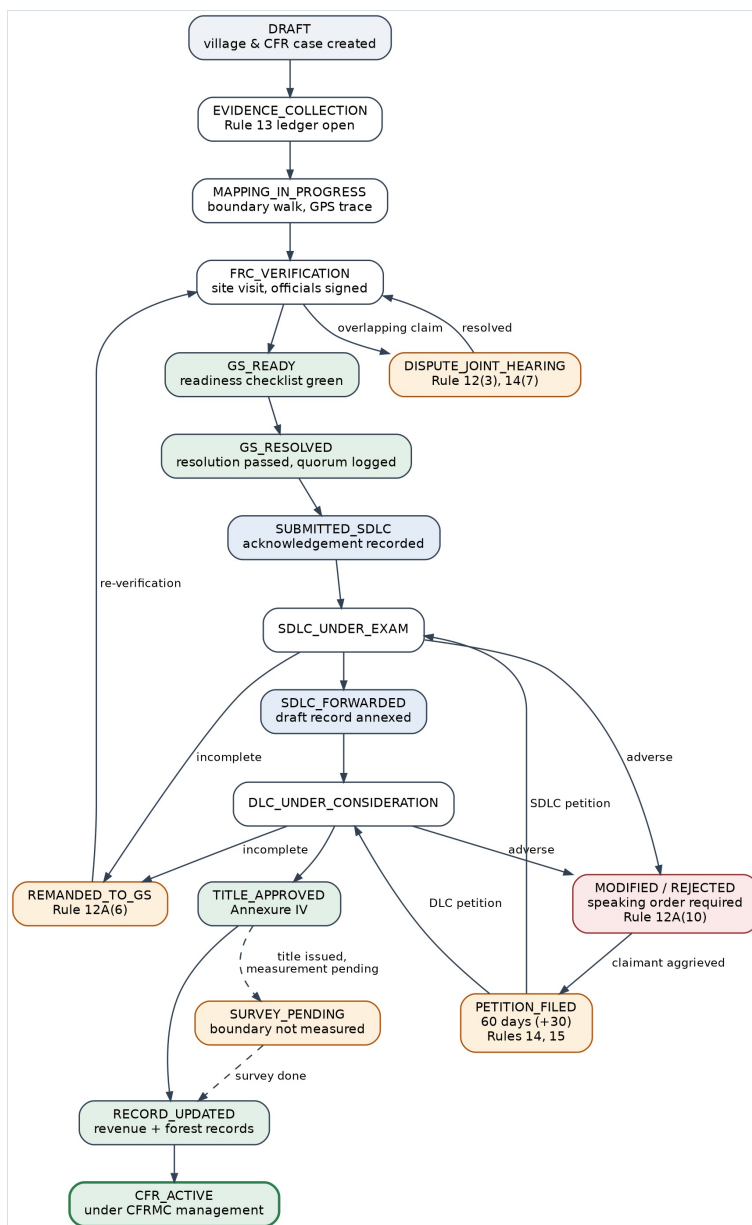


Figure 4 — Claim state machine. Green states are progress states, amber are procedural detours that the law expressly provides for, and red is an adverse order. Note that `REMANDED_TO_GS` is deliberately distinct from rejection, per Rule 12A(6).

State	Owner	Meaning	Permitted next states
DRAFT	NGO / FRC	Case created; nothing statutory has happened.	EVIDENCE_COLLECTION
EVIDENCE_COLLECTION	FRC	Rule 13 ledger open; acknowledgement issued.	MAPPING_IN_PROGRESS
MAPPING_IN_PROGRESS	FRC + elders	Boundary walk and use-zone capture under way.	FRC_VERIFICATION, DISPUTE_JOINT_HEARING
DISPUTE_JOINT_HEARING	Concerned FRCs	Overlap with an adjoining Gram Sabha under Rule 12(3).	MAPPING_IN_PROGRESS, SDLC referral
FRC_VERIFICATION	FRC + departments	Site visit and proceeding sheet.	GS_READY
GS_READY	FRC	Findings and map ready for the Gram Sabha.	GS_RESOLVED
GS_RESOLVED	Gram Sabha	Resolution passed with quorum proof.	SUBMITTED_SDLC
SUBMITTED_SDLC	SDLC office	Packet delivered and acknowledged.	SDLC_UNDER_EXAM
SDLC_UNDER_EXAM	SDLC	Under examination for veracity.	SDLC_FORWARDED, REMANDED_TO_GS, MODIFIED_REJECTED
SDLC_FORWARDED	SDO	Draft record forwarded to the DLC.	DLC_UNDER_CONSIDERATION
DLC_UNDER_CONSIDERATION	DLC	Final approval pending.	TITLE_APPROVED, REMANDED_TO_GS, MODIFIED_REJECTED
MODIFIED_REJECTED	SDLC / DLC	Adverse order; limitation clock running from personal communication.	PETITION_FILED
PETITION_FILED	Claimant / Gram Sabha	Petition under Rule 14 or 15.	SDLC_UNDER_EXAM, DLC_UNDER_CONSIDERATION
TITLE_APPROVED	DLC	Annexure IV title issued.	RECORD_UPDATED, SURVEY_PENDING
SURVEY_PENDING	Land records	Title exists, measurement does not.	RECORD_UPDATED
RECORD_UPDATED	Revenue + Forest	Right incorporated in the records.	CFR_ACTIVE
CFR_ACTIVE	Gram Sabha / CFRMC	Management phase; the claim module hands over.	terminal for this module

6.3 Evidence and document pipeline

Evidence is the module's most sensitive asset: it is collected offline by non-specialists, often from fragile paper, and it must survive scrutiny months later. The pipeline is therefore designed so that no automated step can alter or discard an artefact — assistive steps only add metadata, and a human always attests before an item counts.

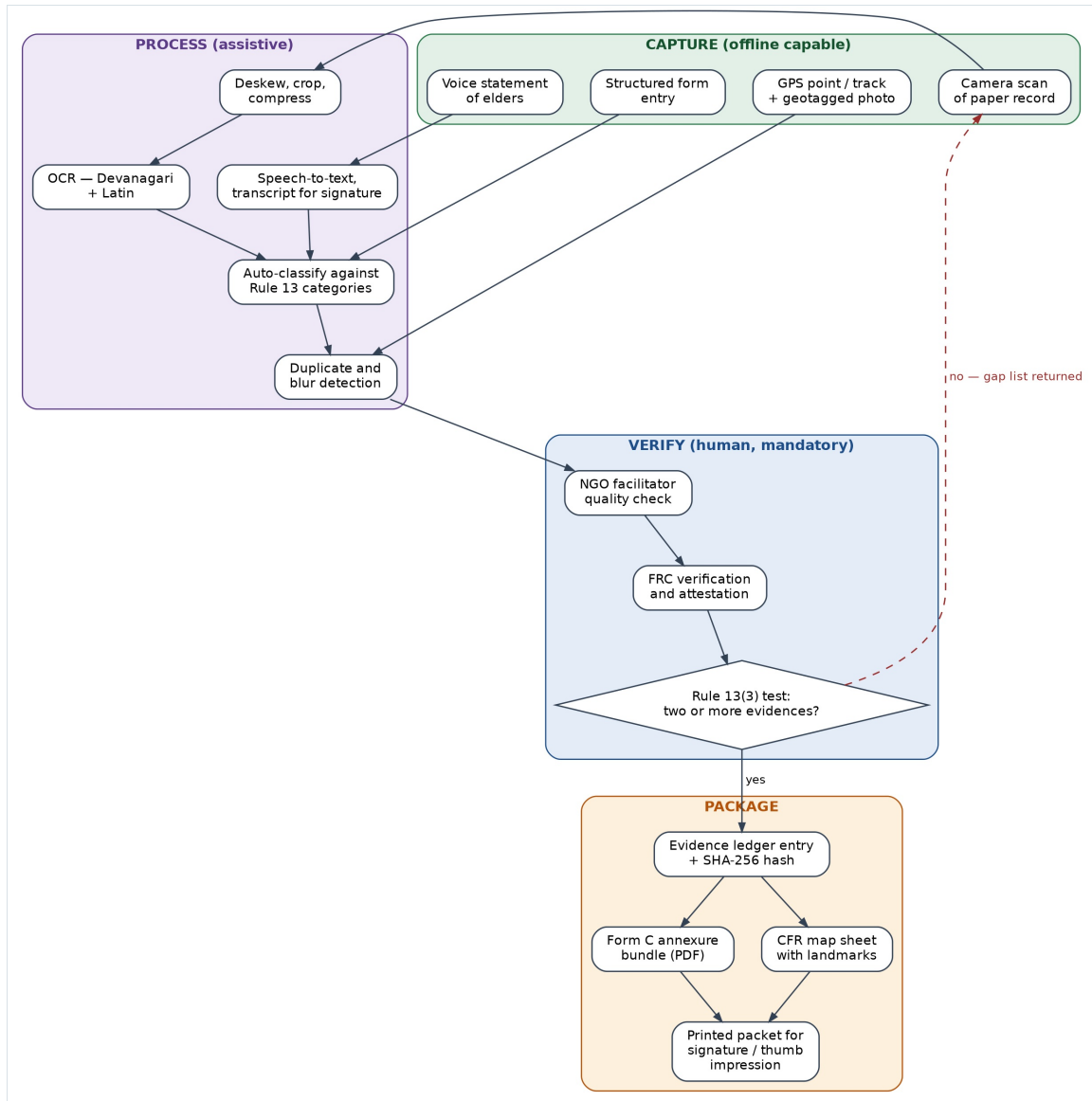


Figure 5 — Evidence pipeline from field capture to the printed statutory packet. The Rule 13(3) sufficiency test is the only gate, and failing it returns a named gap list rather than blocking the claim.

6.4 Geospatial pipeline for the CFR boundary

The polygon that a village produces is a **community assertion of a customary boundary**, not a survey product. The architecture keeps that distinction explicit at the data level: every boundary row carries a `source` and a `status`, and the printed map sheet states its own provenance so that no reader can mistake a participatory map for a cadastral one.

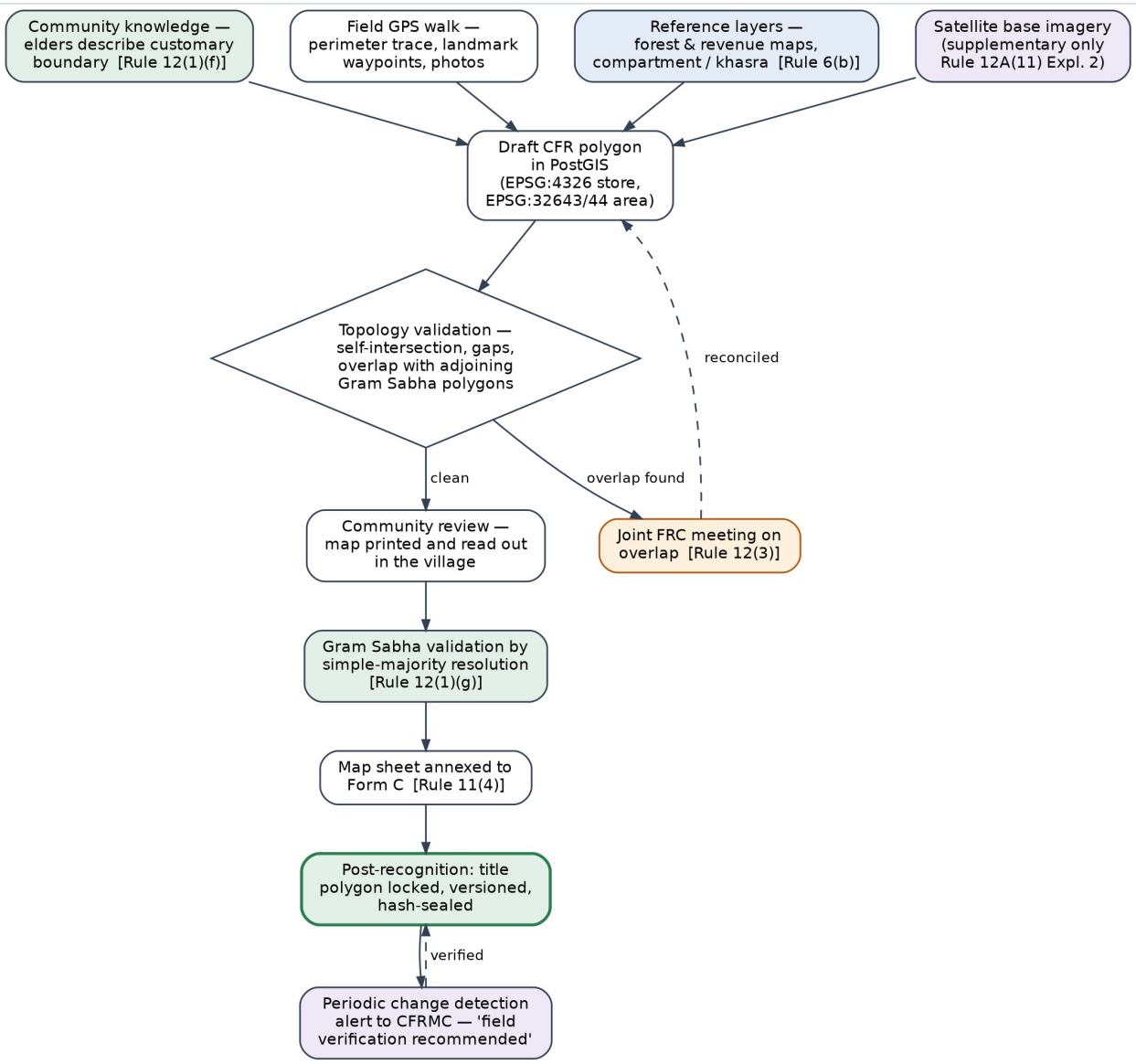


Figure 6 — CFR boundary pipeline. Four independent inputs converge into a PostGIS draft, topology and adjacency are tested before the community sees the map, and the Gram Sabha resolution is what converts a draft into a claimable boundary.

Concern	Design decision
Storage and measurement	Geometry stored in EPSG:4326; area computed in the appropriate UTM zone (EPSG:32643 / 32644 for most of central and western India) so that hectare figures printed on the claim are defensible.
Capture accuracy	Every vertex stores its GNSS accuracy, satellite count and timestamp. Points worse than a configured threshold are drawn differently on the map and listed in the map sheet notes, rather than silently smoothed.
Landmarks	Rule 12(1)(g) requires recognisable landmarks. The module requires at least one landmark per boundary segment and prints a numbered landmark legend, because landmark descriptions — not coordinates — are what the committees and the title deed actually use.
Legal boundaries	Reserved forest, protected forest, sanctuary and national park layers are shown for reference, and the delineation may include them [Rule 12(1)(g) Explanation]. The module never clips the community polygon to them.
Adjacency and overlap	<code>ST_Intersects</code> and <code>ST_Overlaps</code> against neighbouring approved and draft polygons; overlaps raise a Rule 12(3) dispute rather than an error.
Versioning	Boundaries are versioned with validity dates. The version approved by the Gram Sabha resolution is frozen and hash-sealed; the version recorded in the Annexure IV title is frozen again and becomes the reference for post-title monitoring.
Offline maps	Vector tiles and a raster base for the district are pre-packaged onto the device before a field visit, so mapping works with no connectivity.

6.5 Data model

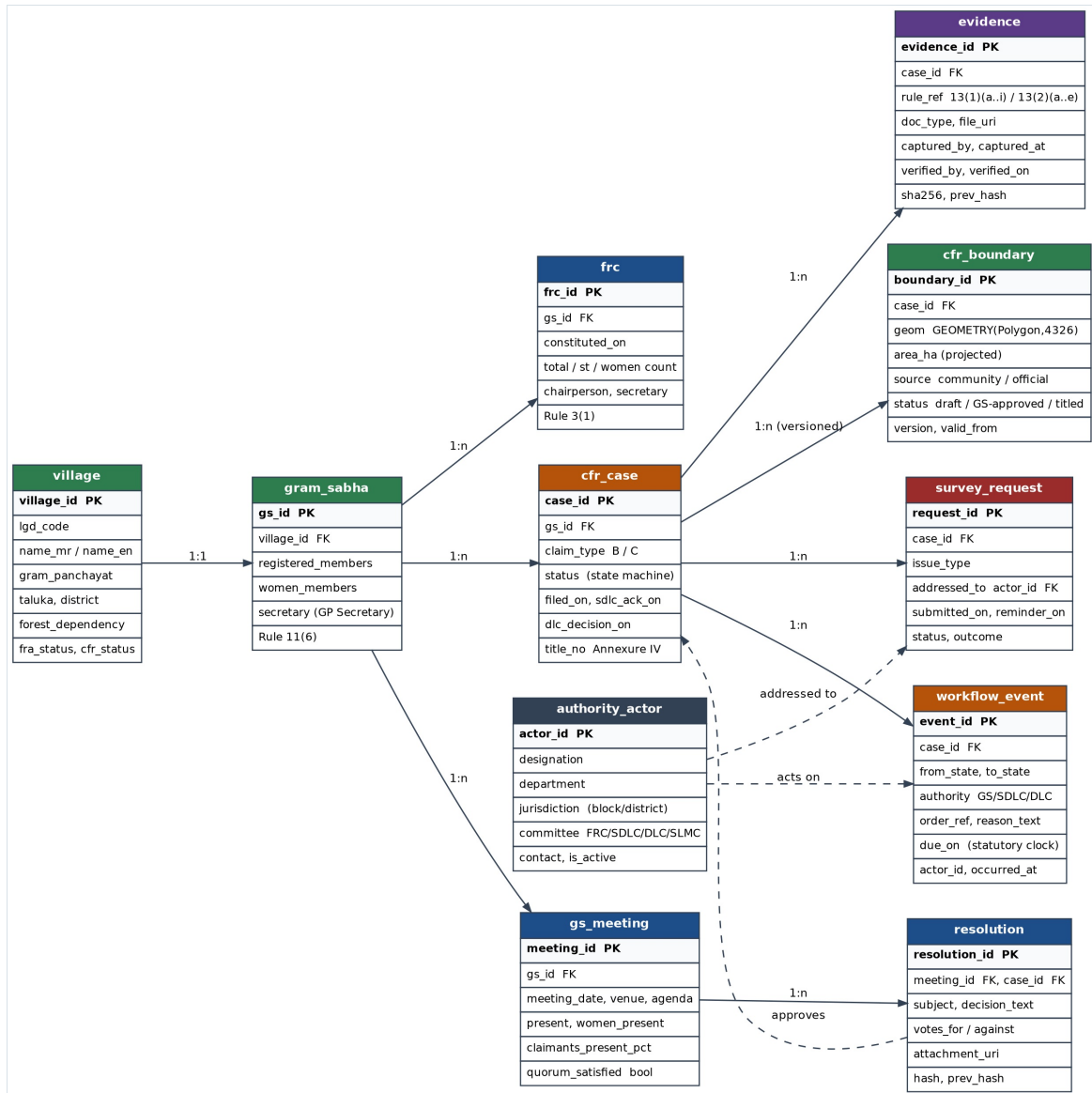


Figure 7 — Core entities of the claim module. Ledger-type entities (evidence, resolution, workflow_event) are append-only and carry hash-chain columns.

Entity	Notes that matter for correctness
village / hamlet	Self-referencing hierarchy with <code>consolidation_status</code> so that unrecorded settlements and forest villages can hold cases before formalisation [Rule 2A].
gram_sabha , gs_member	The roster carries category and gender because three separate statutory computations depend on it: FRC composition, quorum, and the Form C member sheet.
frc , frc_member	Stores the constitution date, the arithmetic proof and the conflict-of-interest flag per member.
case	Discriminated by <code>claim_type</code> ∈ {IFR, CR, CFR} ; CFR cases are owned by the Gram Sabha rather than an individual claimant.
evidence	Append-only. <code>rule_ref</code> is a controlled vocabulary of the Rule 13 sub-clauses. Carries <code>is_substitutable</code> , false for satellite and GPS derivatives.
cfr_boundary	Versioned geometry with source, status, accuracy statistics and the landmark set.
gs_meeting , resolution	The quorum arithmetic is stored, not recomputed later, so that the record reflects what was true on the day.
workflow_event	The audit spine: from-state, to-state, authority, order reference, reason text, statutory due date, actor and timestamp.
authority_actor	Designation, department, jurisdiction, committee and validity dates, so that transfers do not corrupt history.
survey_request , records_request	Outbound correspondence with addressee, dispatch date, reminder schedule and outcome.
consent	Purpose-scoped consent per data subject and per sharing event, with withdrawal.

6.6 API surface (representative)

POST	/api/v1/villages	create / update village and hamlet registry
POST	/api/v1/gram-sabhas/{id}/frc	constitute FRC (validates Rule 3(1) arithmetic)
POST	/api/v1/cases	create claim case {claim_type: CFR}
GET	/api/v1/cases/{id}/readiness	sufficiency engine result with rule citations
POST	/api/v1/cases/{id}/evidence	add evidence {rule_ref, media, captured_by}
POST	/api/v1/cases/{id}/boundary	upsert draft polygon (GeoJSON)
GET	/api/v1/cases/{id}/boundary/conflicts	PostGIS overlap check against neighbours
POST	/api/v1/cases/{id}/verification	field verification proceeding + signature blocks
POST	/api/v1/meetings	create Gram Sabha meeting
POST	/api/v1/meetings/{id}/attendance	attendance; returns live quorum evaluation
POST	/api/v1/meetings/{id}/resolutions	record resolution (blocked if quorum fails)
POST	/api/v1/cases/{id}/transitions	state transition {to_state, authority, order_ref}
POST	/api/v1/cases/{id}/documents/{tpl}	render G-series document (pdf, language)
POST	/api/v1/cases/{id}/orders	record an authority order + communication date
GET	/api/v1/cases/{id}/timeline	statutory clocks and their remaining days
POST	/api/v1/sync/batch	offline outbox drain (idempotent, causal order)
GET	/api/v1/reports/annexure-v	SLMC quarterly return shaped export
GET	/api/v1/reports/coverage	villages with forest dwellers and no CFR case

6.7 Offline-first synchronisation

Connectivity in CFR villages is intermittent by definition, and a field visit can produce hundreds of megabytes of evidence. The synchronisation design assumes weeks offline and treats the device as the temporary system of record.

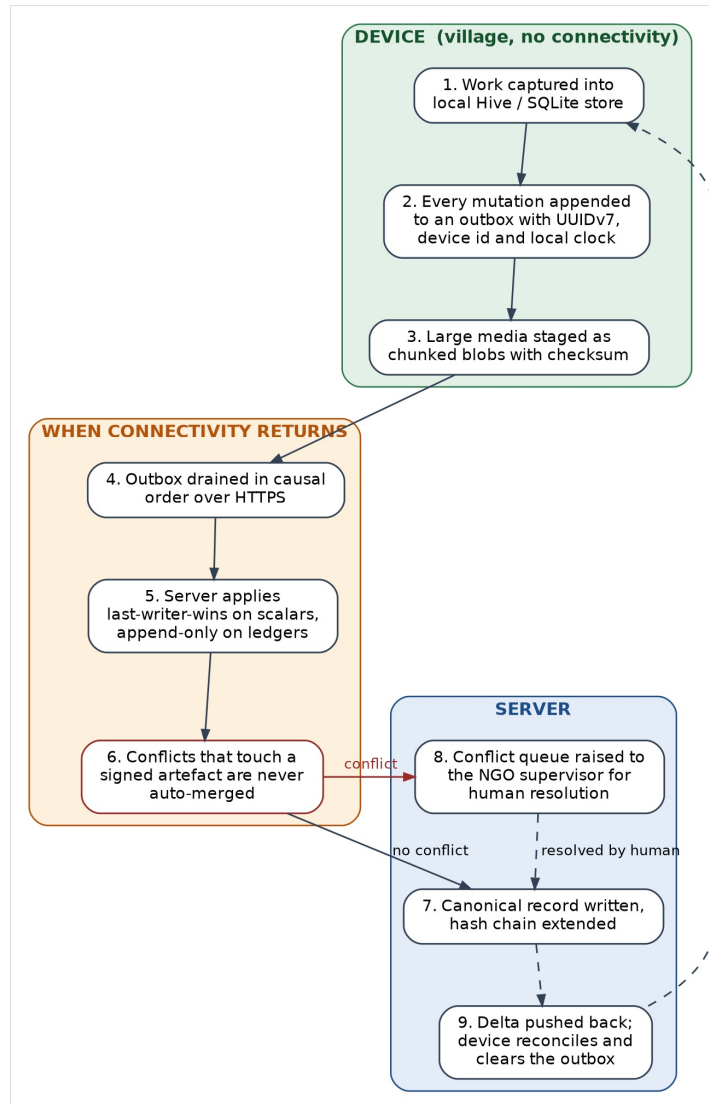


Figure 8 — Offline synchronisation. Scalar fields merge automatically; ledger rows are append-only and therefore never conflict; anything touching a signed artefact is escalated to a human.

Rule	Rationale
UUIDv7 identifiers minted on the device	Cases, evidence and waypoints created in the field must be referenceable before they ever reach the server, and time-ordered identifiers keep the outbox in causal order.
Append-only ledgers never merge	Two devices adding evidence to the same case both succeed; there is nothing to reconcile.
Last-writer-wins on descriptive scalars only	Applies to village population, contact numbers and similar fields where a conflict is harmless.
Signed artefacts are immutable	Any attempt to modify a resolution, a verification proceeding or a titled boundary after signature creates a conflict item for a supervisor, never an automatic overwrite.
Media uploaded in resumable chunks with checksums	A 2G connection that drops must not lose an hour of scanning.
Device vault encrypted; remote wipe on deprovisioning	Field devices are lost and shared; the vault holds identity documents and elder testimony.

6.8 Integrity and audit

The Gram Sabha's record is only useful in a dispute if it can be shown to be unaltered. The module implements a hash chain rather than a blockchain, which is sufficient for tamper evidence and carries no operational burden.

```

record_hash(n) = SHA256( canonical_json(payload(n)) || record_hash(n-1) )

Chained tables : evidence · verification_proceeding · gs_meeting · resolution ·
                workflow_event · title_artefact
Chain scope   : one chain per Gram Sabha, so a village can verify its own history
Anchoring     : the chain head is published weekly to the district instance and
                printed in the Gram Sabha register, giving an offline anchor point
Correction    : never an update – a new row supersedes the old one and records the
                reason, so an amended resolution shows both versions

```

6.9 Deployment

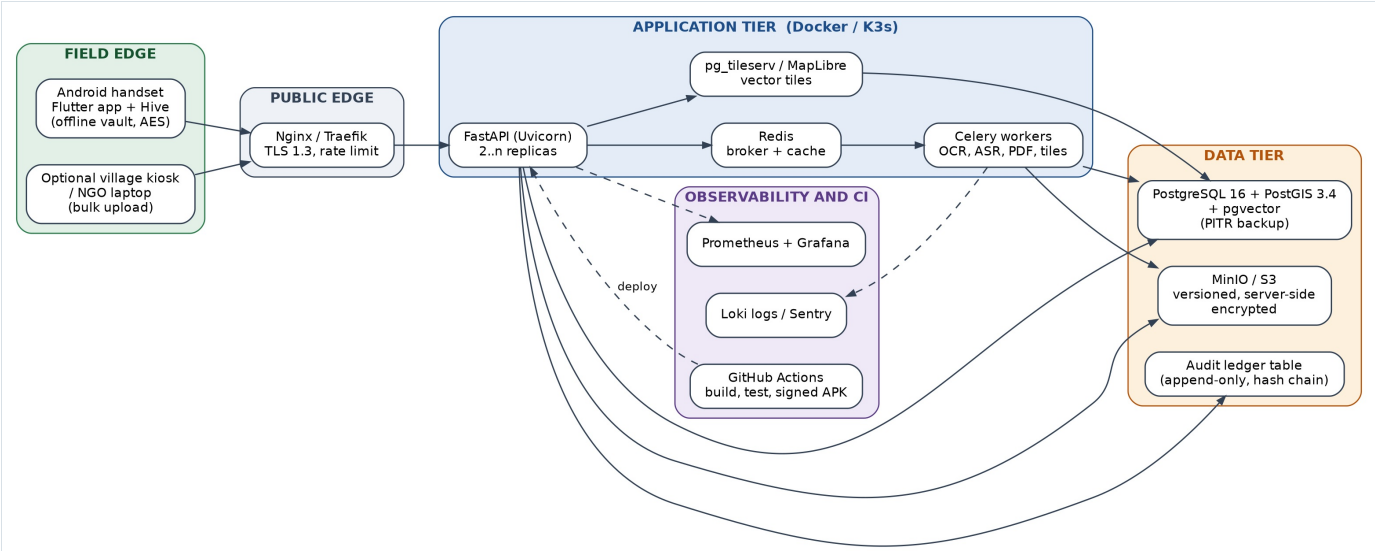


Figure 9 — Deployment topology for a district-scale pilot. The whole application tier fits comfortably on two modest virtual machines; heavy work (OCR, speech-to-text, tile generation, PDF rendering) is queued rather than synchronous.

7 Technology Stack

The stack follows the platform architecture already adopted for VanMitra — Flutter, FastAPI, PostgreSQL and PostGIS — and adds the components the claim module specifically needs. Every choice below is justified against a field constraint, not a preference, and a fallback is named because pilot conditions change.

7.1 Client tier

Component	Choice	Why	Fallback
Mobile application	Flutter 3.x (Android 8+, targeting low-RAM devices)	Single codebase, excellent offline story, strong camera, GPS and local-database plugins, and good Devanagari text rendering.	Kotlin native if device-specific GNSS access becomes necessary.
Local database	Hive for documents and queues; SQLite via Drift for relational queries	Hive is fast for blob-adjacent records and the outbox; Drift gives typed relational queries for case lists and readiness computation.	SQLite only, with a JSON column, if the two-store split proves unnecessary.
Offline maps	MapLibre GL Native with MBTiles / PMTiles packs	Open, no licence cost, renders vector tiles offline, supports drawing and editing polygons in the field.	flutter_map with raster tiles where vector packs are too large.
Location	Android FusedLocation with raw GNSS accuracy exposure	Accuracy must be recorded per vertex, not hidden.	External Bluetooth GNSS receiver for sub-metre work where the district has one.
Media capture	Camera plugin with EXIF geotag, on-device compression and deskew	Evidence quality determines claim quality; capture assistance at the point of capture is worth more than post-processing.	—
Local encryption	SQLCipher / Hive AES with keys in the Android Keystore	Devices carry identity documents and elder testimony.	—
Languages	Marathi, Hindi and English at pilot; string catalogue designed for local tribal languages	Rule and Guideline material must be readable by the Gram Sabha; the Guidelines require communication material in the local language <i>[Guidelines vi(a)]</i> .	Audio-first UI where a script is unavailable.

7.2 Server tier

Component	Choice	Why	Fallback
API framework	FastAPI on Python 3.12, Uvicorn, Pydantic v2	Matches the existing VanMitra backend; Pydantic gives strict schema validation, which is exactly what a statutory form set needs; the Python ecosystem carries the geospatial and document libraries.	—
Workflow	Explicit state machine in application code, backed by the <code>workflow_event</code> table	The statutory transitions are few and must be auditable; a heavyweight BPM engine would obscure them.	Temporal or Camunda if inter-district orchestration grows.
Async work	Celery with Redis	OCR, speech-to-text, tile generation and PDF rendering must never block a field request.	RQ or FastAPI background tasks for a single-district pilot.
Document generation	WeasyPrint (HTML to PDF) with Noto Devanagari fonts; ReportLab for map sheets	Every G-series document must print correctly in Marathi with signature blocks; HTML templates are easy for non-developers to adjust to district practice.	LaTeX for the map sheet if typographic control is needed.
Object storage	MinIO (S3 API), versioned, server-side encrypted	Self-hostable inside a State data centre, which matters for community data.	Any S3-compatible service under a data-residency agreement.
Identity	OIDC (Keycloak) with role and jurisdiction scopes; OTP login for field users	Roles must map to statutory offices and carry a jurisdiction, and field users cannot manage passwords.	FastAPI-native JWT for the pilot.

7.3 Data and geospatial tier

Component	Choice	Why	Fallback
Relational database	PostgreSQL 16	Transactional integrity for the case and ledger tables; row-level security for jurisdiction scoping.	—
Spatial extension	PostGIS 3.4	Topology validation, adjacency, overlap detection and accurate area computation are core statutory requirements, not extras.	—
Vector search	pgvector	Keeps the knowledge-assistant index inside the same database rather than adding a service.	Qdrant if the corpus grows beyond the Act, Rules, Guidelines and State circulars.
Tiles	pg_tileserv or Tegola; PMTiles packs for offline	Serves the same PostGIS geometry to web and mobile without a separate GIS server.	GeoServer where the State already runs one.
Desktop GIS bridge	QGIS with a read-only PostGIS connection	District GIS staff and researchers work in QGIS; the module should meet them there rather than reinvent an editor.	—
Satellite input	Sentinel-2 L2A via an open archive, processed offline into change tiles	Post-title monitoring only; the Rules make imagery supplementary evidence [Rule 12A(11)], so it must never enter the claim as a primary artefact.	Manual periodic review where no processing capacity exists.
Backups	Continuous WAL archiving with point-in-time recovery; nightly encrypted off-site copy	The community record is irreplaceable; paper originals may not survive.	—

7.4 Assistive intelligence tier

Component	Choice	Why	Constraint
OCR	Tesseract 5 with Devanagari, or PaddleOCR for degraded scans	Land records and old orders are typed, stamped and faded; OCR extracts reference numbers and dates for indexing.	Output is metadata only; the scan is the evidence.
Speech to text	Whisper-family model, Marathi and Hindi; on-device small model where possible	Rule 13(1)(i) statements are oral; transcription lowers the cost of reducing them to writing.	The signed printed transcript is the evidence, never the audio or the raw transcript.
Knowledge assistant	Retrieval-augmented generation over the Act, Rules, Guidelines, State circulars and the module's own procedure text	FRC members need answers such as "what happens if the forest official does not come to the site visit" with the rule cited.	Answers must carry citations and must refuse to opine on eligibility or outcome.
Completeness checker	Deterministic rules, not a model	Predictability and explainability outweigh sophistication; the output is a list of missing items with rule citations.	Never expressed as a score or probability.
Change detection	NDVI and land-cover differencing on Sentinel-2 tiles	Supports the CFRMC after recognition.	Alerts are worded as "potential change detected, field verification recommended" and never as an accusation.

7.5 Platform and operations

Concern	Choice
Packaging and orchestration	Docker images; Docker Compose for the pilot, K3s when more than one district is live.
Reverse proxy	Nginx or Traefik with TLS 1.3, HSTS and per-endpoint rate limits.
CI / CD	GitHub Actions: lint, type check, unit and integration tests, signed APK build, container publish, migration dry-run.
Testing	pytest with a PostGIS test container; golden-file tests for every generated statutory document; property tests for the quorum and sufficiency engines; Flutter integration tests for the offline path.
Observability	Prometheus and Grafana for metrics, Loki for logs, Sentry for crashes; a dedicated dashboard for sync failures and for cases approaching a statutory deadline.
Hosting	State or institutional data centre, or an Indian-region cloud, under a data-sharing agreement with the partner NGO and the Gram Sabha.

8 Security, Privacy and Non-Functional Requirements

Requirement	Specification
Data ownership	The community record belongs to the Gram Sabha. The platform operator is a custodian. An exit clause must allow a Gram Sabha to obtain a complete export and to require deletion of its data.
Consent	Purpose-limited, revocable consent recorded per data subject for personal documents and per sharing event for onward disclosure, consistent with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023. Consent is captured in the local language, and orally with a recorded acknowledgement for non-literate members.
Access control	Role plus jurisdiction scoping enforced at the database through row-level security, not only in the API. No role can delete a ledger row.
Sensitive geometry	Precise boundary coordinates and sacred-site locations are restricted; public or research exports are generalised or aggregated to prevent misuse.
Encryption	TLS 1.3 in transit; AES-256 at rest for the database, object store and device vault; keys in a managed store with rotation.
Audit	Every read of personal data and every state transition is logged with actor, time and purpose; audit logs are append-only and retained for the life of the claim plus ten years.
Availability	The field application must function fully offline; server availability targets 99% during working hours, with no data loss tolerated.
Performance	Case list and readiness computation under 300 ms on device; polygon overlap check under 2 s for a district; document generation under 10 s asynchronous.
Accessibility	Large-type and high-contrast modes, icon-led navigation, audio guidance for every screen, and a minimum tap target sized for outdoor use.
Device reality	Target a 2 GB RAM Android device, 720p screen, 2G or intermittent 4G, and battery-conscious GPS sampling during a boundary walk.
Retention	Claim records retained permanently as the community's own archive; personal identity documents purged from the device after successful sync and verification.

9 Business Rule Catalogue

ID	Rule	Basis / effect
BR-01	An FRC cannot be saved unless it has 10 to 15 members, at least two-thirds Scheduled Tribes and not less than one-third women; where there are no Scheduled Tribes, at least one-third women.	Rule 3(1) — hard block.
BR-02	An FRC member flagged as a claimant in a case cannot sign the verification of that case.	Rule 3(3) — hard block with recusal record.
BR-03	A resolution on a forest rights claim cannot be recorded unless all three quorum tests pass.	Rule 4(2) — hard block.
BR-04	A CFR case cannot be marked submitted without a linked Gram Sabha resolution and a Gram-Sabha-approved boundary.	Section 6(1), Rule 12(1)(g) — hard block.
BR-05	A claim shows as evidentially incomplete with fewer than two verified Rule 13(1) evidences, but is not blocked from being forwarded.	Rule 11(1)(a), 13(3) — advisory.
BR-06	Satellite or GPS-derived items cannot satisfy the two-evidence test alone.	Rule 12A(11) Explanation 2 — hard rule in the engine.
BR-07	Field verification cannot be closed without either departmental signatures or a formally recorded absence with an intimation reference.	Rule 12A(1)(2) — hard block.
BR-08	Every boundary segment must carry at least one landmark before the map sheet can be generated.	Rule 12(1)(g) — hard block on document generation.
BR-09	An overlap with a neighbouring polygon forces a dispute sub-state until a joint meeting record or an SDLC referral exists.	Rule 12(3) — hard block.
BR-10	A limitation clock starts from the recorded date of communication in person, and is never inferred from the order date.	Rule 12A(3) — data rule.
BR-11	Remand is recorded as remand and never as rejection.	Rule 12A(6) — state model rule.
BR-12	An adverse order is stored with a field recording whether written reasons were supplied; absence is surfaced as an appeal ground.	Rule 12A(7)(10), Guidelines i(f)(g).
BR-13	A case cannot close while the certified copy of the title or the record incorporation entry is missing.	Rule 8(i), 12A(9) — hard block.

BR-14	No user role in the system may set a claim outcome; outcomes are recorded only from an uploaded authority order.	Constraint C1 — RBAC rule.
BR-15	A signed artefact is immutable; corrections create a superseding record with a reason.	Integrity design.

10 Implementation Roadmap

Phase	Duration	Deliverables	Exit test
P0 — Legal baselining	2 weeks	District register of authorities populated from current notifications; State circulars added to the knowledge corpus; document templates translated and reviewed by the partner NGO.	An FRC member reads each generated document and understands it without help.
P1 — Core case and evidence	6 weeks	Village registry, FRC constitution, case creation, evidence ledger with Rule 13 tagging, acknowledgement, offline capture and sync.	A full evidence bundle captured offline for one village and synced without loss.
P2 — Mapping	5 weeks	Boundary walk, landmarks, use zones, topology and overlap checks, map sheet generation, offline tiles.	A boundary walked, mapped and printed at a scale the Gram Sabha can read.
P3 — Gram Sabha and documents	4 weeks	Meeting, attendance, quorum engine, resolution, the full G-series document set, hash chain.	A real Gram Sabha meeting recorded end to end with a valid quorum computation.
P4 — Workflow and tracking	4 weeks	State machine, statutory clocks, order capture, petition drafting, remand and dispute paths.	A simulated rejection produces a correct petition draft within the limitation period.
P5 — Pilot	1 season	One NGO, one Gram Sabha, one CFR claim carried from calling of claims to submission, with weekly field feedback.	The packet is accepted by the SDLC office without procedural objection.
P6 — Post-title	ongoing	Title capture, record-updation tracking, survey requests, CFRMC handover, Annexure V reporting.	Recognised CFR with the right incorporated in the records and a management plan resolved.

10.1 Responsibility split during the pilot

Activity	Accountable	Responsible	Consulted / informed
Awareness and mobilisation	Gram Sabha	Partner NGO	ITDP Project Officer; Forest Department
Claim preparation and evidence	FRC	FRC with NGO facilitator	Gram Sabha
Boundary delineation	Gram Sabha	FRC with elders and NGO	Adjoining Gram Sabhas; Forest Department
Field verification	FRC	FRC with Forest and Revenue officials	SDLC
Resolution and submission	Gram Sabha	Gram Panchayat Secretary; FRC	SDLC
Statutory processing	SDLC and DLC	SDO; District Collector	Gram Sabha; SLMC
Record incorporation and survey	District Collector	Revenue and Forest Departments; land-record office	Gram Sabha
Platform operation	Implementation team	Implementation team	Gram Sabha as data owner

11 Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
The application is perceived as a parallel government system and is resisted by departments.	High	Position and label it as a community record; brief the SDLC and DLC before the pilot; produce paper output in the exact statutory formats; never claim official status.
A readiness indicator is misread by a committee as an eligibility score.	High	Wording discipline (C2), an explicit disclaimer printed on every export, and no numeric score anywhere.
Participatory map is treated as a cadastral survey.	High	Provenance statement on every map sheet; boundary <code>source</code> and <code>status</code> printed; the survey request workflow exists precisely to route measurement to the competent authority.
Evidence loss through device failure or theft.	High	Encrypted vault, frequent sync, chunked uploads, and a second custodian device in each village cluster.
Personal data exposure of claimants.	High	Consent scoping, row-level security, masked exports, and no public API over personal or precise spatial data.
Officer designations change or differ by district, so letters are misaddressed.	Medium	<code>authority_actor</code> is configuration with validity dates and a periodic re-verification task.
Limitation period lost because an order was communicated orally.	Medium	Communication-date field is mandatory when recording an order; the module prompts the FRC to obtain the order copy in writing.

Low digital literacy limits usage to the NGO worker.	Medium	Audio-first flows, icon navigation, and a printed one-page process card per village; success is measured by FRC use, not NGO use.
Sustainability after the pilot grant ends.	Medium	Open formats, full data export, low-cost hosting footprint, and training of at least two village-level custodians.

12 Appendices

Appendix A — Printable document checklist for a CFR claim

This checklist is generated per case in the local language and is the single sheet an FRC carries to the Gram Sabha meeting.

✓	Item	Rule
	FRC constitution certificate with composition arithmetic	Rule 3(1)
	Notice calling for claims, with date of display	Rule 11(1)(a)
	Intimation to adjoining Gram Sabhas and to the SDLC, with dispatch dates	Rule 11(1)(b)
	Written acknowledgement of the claim	Rule 11(3)
	Form C, fully completed and signed	Rule 11(4)
	Gram Sabha member sheet with ST / OTFD status against each name	Form C, item 5
	CFR map with landmarks, bordering villages and legend	Rule 12(1)(g)
	Schedule of evidence, at least two under Rule 13(1)	Rule 11(1)(a), 13(3)
	Community forest resource evidence under Rule 13(2)	Rule 13(2)
	Statements of elders, reduced to writing and signed	Rule 13(1)(i)
	Boundary delineation record naming the elders who participated	Rule 12(1)(f)
	Field verification proceeding sheet with departmental signatures or recorded absence	Rule 12(1)(a), 12A(1)
	FRC findings report	Rule 12(2)
	Meeting notice, attendance and quorum sheet	Rule 4(2)
	Gram Sabha resolution approving the claim and the map	Rule 12(1)(g)
	Joint meeting record, where a boundary overlap exists	Rule 12(3)
	Covering letter and page-numbered index	Rule 11(5)

Appendix B — Glossary

Term	Meaning as used in this document
CFR	Community Forest Resource — the customary common forest area defined in Section 2(a), over which the right under Section 3(1)(i) is claimed in Form C.
CR	Community Rights under the clauses listed in Rule 2(1)(ca), claimed in Form B.
IFR	Individual Forest Rights, claimed in Form A.
FRC	Forest Rights Committee constituted by the Gram Sabha under Rule 3.
CFRMC	Community Forest Resource Management Committee — in the Rules, the committee constituted under Rule 4(1)(e) for protection of wildlife, forest and biodiversity, working under the control of the Gram Sabha.
SDLC / DLC / SLMC	Sub-Divisional Level Committee, District Level Committee and State Level Monitoring Committee constituted under Section 6 and Rules 5, 7 and 9.
MFP	Minor forest produce as defined in Section 2(i).
OTFD	Other Traditional Forest Dweller as defined in Section 2(o) — three generations, a generation being twenty-five years, prior to 13 December 2005.
PVTG	Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group, referred to in Rule 12B(1); habitat rights arise under Section 3(1)(e).
Nistar	Customary community rights of use, referred to in Section 3(1)(b) and Rule 13(2)(a).
Speaking order	An order that records the reasons for the decision, required for modification or rejection of a Gram Sabha recommendation.

Appendix C — Sources relied upon

1. The Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006 (Act 2 of 2007), published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part II, Section 1, 2 January 2007.
2. The Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Rules, 2007, notified vide G.S.R. 1(E) dated 1 January 2008, as substantially amended by the Amendment Rules, 2012, vide G.S.R. 669(E) dated 6 September 2012 — including Rules 2A, 12A, 12B, Form C and Annexure IV.
3. Ministry of Tribal Affairs, Guidelines on the implementation of the Act — in particular the sections on the process of recognition of

rights, minor forest produce, community rights, community forest resource rights, protection against eviction, and awareness, monitoring and grievance redressal.

4. Marathi-language notification of the 2012 Amendment Rules as applicable in Maharashtra, used for the local-language terminology of the forms and the procedural steps.
5. VanMitra — Final Application Architecture (internal), for the platform-level module structure and technical baseline.
6. VanMitra — Proposed On-Ground Implementation Scheme for FRA and CFR (internal), for the stakeholder model and pilot structure.

Disclaimer. This document is a system design specification derived from published legislation and rules. It is not legal advice. Statutory provisions, State-level rules, Government Resolutions and officer designations change; the district-level configuration and every generated document template must be verified against the instruments in force before the pilot, and re-verified periodically thereafter.

— End of specification · VanMitra CFR Claim Module · Version 1.0 —